

Install solar panels on rooftops and avail subsidy benefits too



PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana



To apply, scan here

For more information, visit: pmsuryaghar.gov.in
Toll Free Number: 15555

सौर ऊर्जा विभाग
MINISTRY OF NEW AND RENEWABLE ENERGY

CBC 28 101/13/0009/2627

BJP's 2029 team takes shape with 3 former CMs, 18 MPs, 12 women

Irani, Madhav make comeback; Deepak Mhaskey new social media head

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 17

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Monday announced its new team of national office-bearers, bringing in a large number of new faces while retaining several experienced leaders in key organisational positions. The much-awaited reshuffle comes seven months after Nitin Nabin took over as the party's 12th national president.

Three former chief ministers, 18 MPs and 12 women are among the 65 office-bearers in the BJP's new national team, signalling a broad mix of political experience, parliamentary representation and organisational strength as the party looks ahead to the 2029 Lok Sabha elections. The new line-up includes several veterans in key positions alongside a large number of younger and first-time office-bearers, with 51 of the 65 appointments being new. The team also draws leaders from 23 states and Union territories, giving the organisation a wider regional footprint as the BJP prepares for the electoral challenges ahead.

Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has been appointed national treasurer, a post he held from 2010 to 2014. His father, Ved



I AM CONFIDENT THEY WILL GIVE THEIR BEST IN STRENGTHENING OUR PARTY AND FOCUSING ON PUBLIC SERVICE. MY BEST WISHES TO THEM

Prakash Goyal, who served as a Union minister in the Atal Bihari Vajpayee government, had also held the post for a long period. Goyal is the only Union minister inducted into the new organisational team.

Former Union minister Smriti Irani has returned to the party's central structure as a national general secretary. Former RSS functionary Ram Madhav has also made a comeback as a national vice-president.

The BJP retained B L Santhosh as national general secretary (organisation), while Vinod

Tawde and Sunil Bansal are the only two national general secretaries retained from the previous team. Bansal had played a key organisational role in Uttar Pradesh and was also involved in the party's campaign in the West Bengal Assembly polls.

Former Tripura chief minister Biplab Kumar Deb has been inducted as one of the party's eight national general secretaries. BJP MP and former Rajasthan unit president Satish Poonia, Lok Sabha MP Gajendra Patel, Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Bhatia and

KEY POINTS

- » **PIYUSH GOYAL** appointed national treasurer
- » **SMRITI IRANI** returns as a national general secretary
- » **RAM MADHAV** returns as national vice-president
- » **B L SANTHOSH** retained as BJP national general secretary (organisation)
- » **BIPLAB KUMAR DEB** joins the team as a national general secretary
- » **VINOD TAWDE** and Sunil Bansal retained as national general secretaries
- » **BJP INCREASES** national vice-presidents from 11 to 13
- » **NINE OF THE 13** national vice-presidents are new faces
- » **NATIONAL GENERAL secretaries** increase from seven to eight
- » **BJP EXPANDS** national secretaries from 11 to 16
- » **FOURTEEN OF 16** national secretaries are new faces
- » **ANIL BALUNI** retained as BJP media in-charge
- » **THREE NEW** media co-convenors appointed to assist Anil Baluni
- » **AMIT MALAVIYA** replaced as IT department head by Deepak Mhaskey

STUDENTS INSIST ON CBI PROBE

Jharkhand cancels JSSC-CGL, all exams by TDPL since 2014



Student leader Devendra Nath Mahato after Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren's announcement

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ranchi, August 17

Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren on Monday announced the cancellation of the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination and all recruitment tests conducted by out-sourced agency TSR Data Processing Pvt Ltd (TDPL) since 2014, as protests over alleged irregularities entered their 24th day.

The decision was taken at a marathon cabinet meeting chaired by Soren. He said the government would also cancel the results published by TDPL. "The government has

KEY POINTS

- » Results published by TSR Data Processing Pvt Ltd will also be cancelled
- » Cancellation of JSSC-CGL was a key demand of protesting students
- » Soren announced an examination reforms committee headed by IAS officer Amitabh Kaushal
- » The committee will examine measures to reform recruitment examinations

decided to cancel the JSSC-CGL exam, which was one of the major demands of the protesting students," Soren said after the meeting.

If so serious, why were you quiet? SC raps ED, CBI in Rahul asset case

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 17

The Supreme Court on Monday restrained the CBI and Enforcement Directorate from submitting any further investigation report before the Allahabad High Court in a case alleging that Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi owns assets disproportionate to his known sources of income and directed the high court to defer its next hearing, scheduled for August 20, until further orders.

A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana issued notices to Gandhi, BJP worker S Vignesh Shishir, the CBI and the ED while hearing Gandhi's challenge to orders passed by the high court. "Meanwhile, no report shall be submitted by the CBI, ED or any other agency in terms of the Allahabad High Court's order," the bench said.

The court questioned the probe agencies over their decision not to act independently if they already had material suggesting a cognisable offence. Addressing Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, who appeared for the agencies, the bench asked, "If it is so serious, why has your agency kept quiet? Do you need a direction from the court? Have you taken any suo motu action? No, right?"

The bench also questioned whether Gandhi had been given a proper

Briefs

Russia hits Indian tycoon's factory in Ukr

MOSCOW: A Russian missile strike hit ArceelorMittal Kryvyi Rih, Ukraine's largest integrated steel plant, killing two workers and injuring 14, while damaging energy and blast-furnace operations and forcing a partial production halt. The attack came after Ukraine launched one of its largest drone barrages against Russia.

Russia's Defence Ministry said 822 Ukrainian drones were intercepted overnight. Moscow Mayor Sergei

India leases MQ-9B Sea Guardian

NEW DELHI: The Defence Ministry on Monday signed a Rs 1,943-crore contract with General Atomics Aeronautical Systems Inc (GA-ASI) to lease two MQ-9B Sea Guardian High Altitude Long Endurance (HALE) Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS) for the Indian Navy. The 30-month lease is aimed at strengthening India's maritime surveillance and reconnaissance capabilities in the Indian Ocean Region (IOR).

Govt adviser calls for E10 petrol option to protect older vehicles

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 17

India should bring back a lower-ethanol petrol option such as E10 to protect millions of older two-wheelers while continuing its ethanol programme, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran and Department of Economic Affairs consultant Akash Poojari have said in a joint opinion piece.

E20 petrol, containing 20 per cent ethanol, has been the only petrol variant available at fuel stations since April 1. The policy aims to reduce crude oil imports, support farmers and cut emissions. The gov-



DISMISSING COMPLAINTS OUT-RIGHT WOULD BE A MISTAKE BECAUSE BENEATH THE NOISE LIES A REAL PROBLEM AND A MUCH LARGER QUESTION,

ernment has rejected claims that E20 causes widespread vehicle damage and has said supplying multiple fuel grades would be difficult and costly.

Nageswaran and Poojari said evidence did not support claims of widespread engine damage in E20-compatible vehicles. However, they said

concerns about older two-wheelers should not be dismissed. India has an estimated 75 to 80 million two-wheelers built before BS-IV standards, many using carburetors.

Unlike modern fuel-injection systems, carburetors cannot adjust automatically to the additional

CM ANNOUNCES RS 4 LAKH AID Bihar temple stampede kills 7 women

MPOST BUREAU
Lakhisarai (Bihar), August 17

Seven women devotees died and 25 others were injured in a stampede near Ashok Dham temple in Bihar's Lakhisarai district on Monday morning, officials said.

The incident took place around 6.30 am at Ashok Dham Halt railway station, located a short walk from the temple. According to District Magistrate Shailendra Kumar, a section of the barricades collapsed under pressure from the large crowd, causing devotees to fall over one another.

The situation worsened after rumours spread that an electric pole had fallen and that current was passing through the area, trig-



A view of the area of the stampede where seven people died at Ashokdham, in Lakhisarai on Monday

gering panic among the pilgrims. "At least seven women devotees died, and 25 others were

injured in the stampede near Ashok Dham halt railway station," Kumar said.

AFTER UGC-NET PAPER ERRORS NTA axes over 50 staff members, undertakes system overhaul

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

The National Testing Agency (NTA) has begun a broad restructuring of its examination system, including the removal of more than 50 staff members, the appointment of specialised professionals and a security overhaul, after errors were found in three UGC-NET papers and the agency ordered their re-conduct. Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi reviewed the measures with the Secretary of the Department of Higher Education, the NTA Director General and senior officials, directing the agency to tighten examination protocols and audit all stages of its processes.

KEY POINTS

- » NTA will fill 10 specialised leadership positions to strengthen examination management
- » Posts include CTO, CFO, CISO, test security and psychometrics heads
- » Private-sector specialists will join NTA for cybersecurity and question-paper design
- » Secluded rooms, air-gapped systems and device-deposit protocols will be strengthened

The NTA said it received complaints about multiple errors in the English, Commerce and Sociology



- » Joshi orders complete overhaul of NTA's Confidential Operations architecture
- » NTA must strictly follow established examination protocols at every stage.
- » Agency ordered to identify procedural gaps and implement corrective measures

papers of the UGC-NET June 2026 examination. A committee formed to examine the

Bengal: 9 die in hotel blaze in temple town Tarapith



Rescue personnel carry out operations after a fire broke out at a hotel

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata/Alipurduar, August 17

At least nine people were killed after an inferno tore through a four-storey hotel in Tarapith, Birbhum, in the early hours of Mon-

day, trapping pilgrims in their rooms as thick smoke turned the building into a death trap.

Police have, so far, arrested the hotel owner's son for alleged lapses in maintaining the fire-fight-

ing system and detained another person.

PM Modi announced an ex-gratia of Rs 2 lakh for the next of kin of each deceased and Rs 50,000 for each injured person, while Chief

TRAGEDY

- » The blaze broke out around 4.30 am, when most guests were asleep, with thick smoke trapping several people on the upper floors
- » PM Modi announced Rs 2 lakh for the next of kin of each deceased and Rs 50,000 for each injured person
- » Five of the deceased were members of a family from Meghalaya, while four others were residents of Alipurduar

PM announces ex-gratia

MCD worker’s death sparks sanitation workers’ protest

Kalyanpuri killing: Rs 1 cr compensation sought for kin

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Sanitation workers and auto-tipper drivers from across Delhi staged a protest at Lal Bahadur Shastri Hospital on Monday, demanding Rs 1 crore compensation and a permanent government job for one member of the family of a 27-year-old sanitation worker who was stabbed to death while collecting garbage in Kalyanpuri.

The protestors gathered at the hospital, where the body of Anil was kept, and raised slogans demanding the immediate arrest of the accused, compensation for his family and action against the private company that had engaged him. Delhi Police and paramilitary personnel were deployed at the hospital as workers refused to allow the family to take the body for the last rites until their demands were addressed.

“We are demanding Rs 1 crore compensation for the family and a permanent job in MCD for one member of the family,” said Karan Singh Mahroliya, a member of the Delhi Sanitation Workers Union.

“We will not allow the last rites until our demands are met. Auto-tippers will remain off the roads across Delhi,” he said, adding that vehicles remained off the



Sanitation workers stage a protest at the MCD headquarters

JUSTICE SOUGHT

- » The protestors gathered at the hospital, where the body of Anil was kept, and raised slogans demanding the immediate arrest of the accused, compensation for his family and action against the private company that had engaged him
- » ‘We will not allow the last rites until our demands are met. Auto-tippers will remain off the roads across Delhi’
- » Delhi Police and paramilitary personnel were deployed at the hospital as workers refused to allow the family to take the body for the last rites until their demands were addressed

roads in several areas as part of the protest.

Police said a man has been arrested in connection with the killing, but his identity has not been disclosed. The motive behind the killing is yet to be ascertained, and all possible angles are being examined.

Anil, a contractual san-

itation worker engaged by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) through a private company, was allegedly stabbed while collecting garbage in Kalyanpuri at around 8.15 am on Sunday. He was rushed to Lal Bahadur Shastri Hospital, where he later succumbed to his injuries.

Burglary at DCP’s Kaka Nagar home solved in 24 hours

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

A burglary at the residence of a Delhi Police DCP in the upscale Kaka Nagar area was solved within 24 hours, with the police arresting one accused and detaining two, official sources said on Monday.

Sources added that all the stolen articles, including an iPhone, diamond ring, cash and important documents, have been recovered.

“We have arrested one person and detained two others. Further questioning is underway,” a senior police officer said, requesting anonymity.

The incident took place on August 11 when the officer left his residence around 5.30 am for duty. He returned around 8 am and found the house ransacked, following which the Tughlak Road police station was informed.

According to police sources, the officer had left through a door near the kitchen which could not be locked. On returning, he found several belongings missing from the house.

Items stolen included an iPhone, diamond ring, Rs 10,000 cash, wallets, cards and identity documents. Police registered a case at Tughlak Road police station and recovered the stolen articles within 24 hours after CCTV and technical investigations, arresting one person.

Uncle, nephew killed as e-rickshaw battery explosion triggers fire

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Two persons, including a 17-year-old boy, were killed after a suspected blast in an e-rickshaw battery triggered a fire at a godown in west Delhi’s Raghubir Nagar early Monday, police said.

Mohammad Sufed (17) and his maternal uncle Sahmad (38), both residents of Bhagalpur in Bihar, were killed in the fire that broke out as they were charging e-rickshaw batteries on the premises, they said.

The Delhi Fire Service (DFS) received a call at 4:42 am reporting the fire that broke out on the first floor of the five-storey building in Raghubir Nagar.

Domestic articles stored on the first floor caught fire following the suspected battery blast, the fire department said.

The blaze was brought under control at around 5:30 am, a fire officer said.

According to police, a team reached the spot after receiving a PCR call about the fire and shifted Sufed and Sahmad to the Guru Gobind Singh Hospital, where doctors declared them dead.

Sufed lived in the building with his father, Mohammad Naseeb, and Sahmad. All three were e-rickshaw drivers and used to charge their batteries at the rented



KEY POINTS

- » The Delhi Fire Service (DFS) received a call at 4:42 am reporting the fire that broke out on the first floor of the five-storey building in Raghubir Nagar
- » Domestic articles stored on the first floor caught fire following the suspected battery blast, the fire department said
- » The blaze was brought under control at around 5:30 am: Fire officer
- » A team reached the spot after receiving a PCR call about the fire and shifted Sufed and Sahmad to the Guru Gobind Singh Hosp, where doctors declared them dead

Briefs

Hosp guard seen preping syringes

NOIDA: A security guard and a staff nurse at District Hospital, Sector 39, have been suspended after a video allegedly showed the guard preparing syringes with medication for patients. The incident reportedly occurred on August 14 in the hospital’s fifth-floor medical ward. Officials said the guard, employed through an outsourcing agency, was not trained medical personnel. The hospital has initiated an inquiry and issued a notice to the agency.

BJP flags morphed Nabin photo

NEW DELHI: The Delhi BJP on Monday lodged a police complaint over an alleged morphed photograph showing party president Nitin Nabin holding the national flag upside down. A three-member delegation met Special Commissioner of Police Devesh Srivastava and sought an investigation, FIR and action against those behind its creation and circulation on social media. Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra alleged the image was intended to spread misinformation.

Noida: Two suicide cases reported

NOIDA: A 54-year-old Delhi woman allegedly died by suicide after jumping from the seventh floor of a high-rise society in Sector 78 on Monday, police said. Identified as Prabhjot Kaur of Vikaspuri, she had been staying with her sister’s family for three days. Police said she had told them she was going for a walk before the incident. No suicide note was found. In a separate incident, a 24-year-old woman allegedly died by suicide at a house in Allahabas village under Phase 2 police station on Sunday. Both cases are under investigation.

Worker dies after falling in 10-ft waterlogged pit

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 17

A 32-year-old factory worker died after reportedly falling into an eight to 10-foot-deep waterlogged pit on a vacant private plot while returning home from work in Delhi’s Rohini late Thursday night, police said.

The deceased, identified as Himanshu Pal, worked at a private factory in Mundka and lived near the plot in Brij Vihar, Prem Nagar. The incident occurred around 11 pm when Pal was returning home after his evening shift. Police were alerted through a PCR call received at Prem Nagar Police Station.

A neighbour reportedly

spotted Pal floating in the water and raised an alarm. Several residents gathered at the spot and attempted to rescue him using a rope, but their efforts failed.

Pal’s father, Raj Kumar, said his son had left for work around 4 pm. Police suspect he may have accidentally fallen into the pit and said the case was prima facie accidental, though all possibilities were being examined.

The plot owner has not been identified. Police are also probing how the pit became waterlogged and whether rainfall was responsible. The body has been sent for post-mortem examination.

Pal is survived by his wife and three-year-old son.

BMS workers protest at Jantar Mantar

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Hundreds of members of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)-affiliated Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh (BMS) gathered at Jantar Mantar on Monday, urging the Centre to address a range of pending issues concerning workers, pensioners, contractual employees and those employed under government schemes.

The demonstration formed part of a nationwide campaign by the trade union, which said it was seeking an early dialogue with the government on labour welfare and social security measures.

Among its principal demands is the introduction of a minimum monthly wage of Rs.30,000 for unskilled



workers. The organisation has also sought an increase in the minimum pension under the Employees’ Pension Scheme (EPS-95) to Rs.7,500, linked with Variable Dearness Allowance (VDA), along with health coverage under the Ayushman Bharat scheme.

The BMS has further called for raising the wage ceiling for Employees’ Provident Fund (EPF) eligibility from Rs.15,000 to Rs.30,000 and for Employees’ State Insurance (ESI) from Rs.21,000 to Rs.42,000. It has also

demanded restoration of the Old Pension Scheme, filling vacant government posts, implementation of pending wage settlements and a five-day work week for the banking sector.

According to, BMS national vice-president Pawan Kumar said the union was seeking stronger safeguards for contractual workers, including equal pay for equal work and better job security. He also said the government should reconvene the Indian Labour Confer-

ence, which has not met since 2015, to facilitate discussions on labour-related concerns.

Members of the Auto Rickshaw Sangh have also raised transport-related issues before the Delhi government. The union demanded the immediate constitution of an Auto-Taxi Drivers’ Welfare Board, saying it was essential to safeguard the interests and welfare of auto and taxi drivers. Protesters also called for the rollback of the recently increased vehicle fitness fees, argu-

ing that the higher charges had placed an additional financial burden on drivers already struggling with rising operating costs.

The union additionally sought higher honorariums for Anganwadi, ASHA, Mid-Day Meal and National Health Mission workers, stricter action against contractors involved in wage theft, enhanced gratuity benefits and a dedicated policy for scheme workers. It also reiterated its opposition to provisions of the Industrial Relations Code and the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, arguing that several clauses do not adequately protect workers’ interests. The union would review the response to Monday’s demonstrations before deciding its next course of action.

Man found dead in Naraina Vihar

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 17

An unidentified man, aged around 30, was found dead in a pool of blood near Sarvodaya Kanya Vidyalaya in Naraina Vihar, West Delhi, on Monday, police said.

Police received information about the body from locals and a PCR call at around 7 am, following which a team reached the spot. The man was found naked with multiple injuries to his head and hand, with a substantial amount of blood around his head.

During inspection, police found a tattoo bearing the names “Anand” and “Renu” on his left forearm and are trying to establish his identity. Police said the death prima facie appeared to be homicidal. A probe has been launched.

OPEN GYMS, NEW PLAY ZONES ON THE WAY

New Delhi area parks set for makeover

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Neighbourhood parks in the New Delhi constituency are set for a makeover, with the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) taking up a Rs 3.91-crore project to install open-air gyms and upgrade play areas for children, officials said on Monday.

According to the officials, the project, being implemented under the CMD Fund Scheme, is aimed at making local parks more useful and inviting for residents, with facilities for both fitness and recreation being added to neighbourhood green spaces.

“Under the project, parks will get new open-air gym equipment to encourage residents to exercise outdoors. Children’s play areas will also be revamped with equipment such as swings, slides and other play structures,” officials said.

The initiative is expected to benefit residents who use these parks for their daily walks, exercise and recreation, while giving children dedicated spaces to play closer to home, they added.

According to the schedule of quantities, the work involves sup-

CLOSER LOOK

- » The initiative is expected to benefit residents who use these parks for their daily walks, exercise and recreation, while giving children dedicated spaces
- » ‘Under the project, parks will get new open-air gym equipment to encourage residents to exercise outdoors. Children’s play areas will also be revamped with equipment such as swings, slides and other play structures...’
- » NDMC has begun selecting contractors through e-procurement bidding. The work is scheduled to be completed within six months from commencement

plying and fixing 12 varieties of multi-activity play units – 26 structures in all – at parks and playgrounds across the constituency, along with 42 spring-mounted duck rockers, 42 horse-shaped spring rockers, 42 merry-go-rounds and 42 double-user seesaws.

The NDMC has begun selecting contractors through e-procurement bidding. The work is sched-

uled to be completed within six months of commencement.

The civic body has also included environmental safeguards in the project to minimise inconvenience to residents during the construction and installation work.

Officials said the contractors will have to comply with Central Public Works Department standards and National Green Tribunal guidelines, including measures to control dust at work sites. This is intended to ensure that the installation work does not unnecessarily affect air quality in and around the parks.

With the proposed additions, the parks are expected to become more active community spaces, combining greenery with facilities for exercise, children’s play and everyday recreation, officials added.

The Dr Rajendra Prasad Centre for Ophthalmic Sciences (RPC), AIIMS New Delhi, on Sunday launched the Modular Retina Training Programme at the National Retina Skill Development Centre, a first-of-its-kind facility aimed at strengthening retinal care across India.

Launched by RPC chief Prof Radhika Tandon and Roche India Healthcare Institute (RIHI) director Rajji Mehdwan, the programme has been developed in partnership with RIHI to provide hands-on training, research

AIIMS: Retina care gets training boost

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, August 17

and innovation in retinal diseases.

The Centre’s Retina Skill Lab CORE (Comprehensive Retinal Education) is equipped with high-resolution OCTs, fundus cameras and specialised microscopes.

It plans to train over 100 ophthalmologists from the public health system over three years through eight structured modules covering early detection, diagnosis and management.

With retinal disorders among the leading causes of irreversible vision loss, the initiative aims to expand specialist skills and help reduce preventable blindness.

Although every possible care and caution has been taken to avoid errors or omissions, this publication is being sold on the condition and understanding that information given in this publication is merely for reference and must not be taken as having authority of or binding in any way on the writers, editors, publishers, and printers and sellers who do not owe any responsibility for any damage or loss to any person, a purchaser of this publication or not for the result of any action taken on the basis of this work. All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent court and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only.

खादी ग्रामोद्योग से

2+करोड़

लोगों को मिल रहा रोजगार

खादी- स्वदेशी से समृद्धि तक का सफर

खादी इंडिया को फॉलो करें @kvicindia | kvic.gov.in

अधिक जानकारी के लिए स्कैन करें

CBC 25103/43 0007/2627

Kalyanwas, Bahapur & Gulabi Bagh to get new PWD housing

Colonies to get high-rise housing, commercial spaces...

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 17

The Delhi government is set to redevelop its ageing Public Works Department (PWD) housing colonies into high-rise residential complexes under the Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) policy, with the first phase covering Gulabi Bagh, Kalyanwas in Mayur Vihar and Bahapur near Defence Colony. The projects will be executed on a self-financing model similar to the Centre’s General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA) scheme.

PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh Verma told *Millennium Post* that the government plans to maximise land use while generating revenue to fund redevelopment and the proposed Delhi Secretariat at ITO.

At Kalyanwas, spread over 32 acres, and Gulabi Bagh, residential towers will be developed along with commercial spaces. Under TOD norms, nearly 10 per cent of the total built-up area has been earmarked for commercial use, while the remaining 90 per cent will comprise residential units. “We intend to utilise the entire permissible FAR to build high-rise complexes. After meeting the housing requirement of government employees, the remaining residential units and commercial space will be monetised so



“THE GOVT HAS IDENTIFIED SEVEN ADDITIONAL LOCATIONS FOR SIMILAR REDEVELOPMENT

that the projects finance themselves,” Verma said.

The redevelopment will cover nearly 70 lakh sq ft at Kalyanwas and 2.25 crore sq ft at Gulabi Bagh. Revenue generated from these projects will also be used to finance construction of the new Delhi Secretariat.

Bahapur, unlike the other two sites, will be developed exclusively for housing. Around 160 Type V and Type VI flats are proposed there. Verma said the tender would be floated next week, while the project, estimated to cost Rs.400 crore, would soon be placed before the Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) for approval. Around 4 lakh sq ft of built-up area is planned at the site. The minister said the redevelopment is aimed at replacing dilapidated government accommodation. “Many officials posted in

URBAN RENEWAL

- » The redevelopment will cover nearly 70 lakh sq ft at Kalyanwas and 2.25 crore sq ft at Gulabi Bagh. Revenue generated from these projects will also be used to finance construction of the new Delhi Secretariat
- » The minister said the redevelopment is aimed at replacing dilapidated government accommodation
- » Bahapur, unlike the other two sites, will be developed exclusively for housing. Around 160 Type V and Type VI flats are proposed there
- » Verma said the tender would be floated next week, while the project, estimated to cost Rs.400 crore, would soon be placed before the EFC for approval

Delhi struggle to get quality government housing. Our objective is to provide better living conditions and modern residential complexes,” he said.

Officials said the General Administration Department (GAD) has been asked to assess the government’s requirement for flats and prepare estimates on the number of units to be retained and their pricing. After meeting official requirements, the remaining flats will be opened for sale. Verma said Central government departments, the CPWD, public sector undertakings and private buyers will be eligible to purchase them, while the open-market component will be disposed of through auctions. Consultants will be appointed for Gulabi Bagh and Kalyanwas to prepare detailed project reports, cost estimates and

the financial model. The projects will include Type II, III and IV flats and are expected to take three to four years to complete.

Besides the first three colonies, the government has identified seven additional locations for similar redevelopment, including Probyn Road, Timarpur, Sindhora Khurd, Sindhora Kalan and Vikas Bhawan. Gulabi Bagh, Sindhora Kalan and Sindhora Khurd together comprise around 1,200 Type I, II and III government quarters, while Probyn Road and Timarpur have 16 Type V and 90 Type III quarters. Officials said private developers would be engaged to construct residential and office complexes, recovering investments through the sale of residential units, commercial space and, where feasible, surplus land parcels.

Yamuna bank to be developed on lines of Sabarmati Riverfront: Min

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

The Delhi government will develop the Yamuna bank on the lines of Sabarmati Riverfront in Gujarat, Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Monday.

Singh is on a study visit to Gujarat with officials from the Delhi Irrigation and Flood Control (I&FC) Department and Delhi Jal Board (DJB).

The minister said that the Delhi government is also working to build a grand Chhath Ghat along the Yamuna in Kalindi Kunj.

“We saw that all the issues that existed in the Sabarmati Riverfront 25-30 years ago are the same issues we face in the Yamuna in Delhi currently. We are also working on the Yamuna riverfront in Delhi just like the Sabarmati Riverfront,” Singh said at a press conference.

The minister said the government is planning to build “big, beautiful parks”, cycle tracks, and sports grounds along the river.

Delhi will study the Sabarmati Riverfront model for Yamuna redevelopment, including shifting dhobi ghats and introducing mechanised laundry facilities.

The upcoming Chhath ghat at Kalindi Kunj will cost Rs 60 crore, while a committee is examining CAG reports on DJB.

Delhi govt cleanliness drive offers Rs 1 cr monthly prize for top ward

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 17

In a bid to turn cleanliness into a public movement, the Delhi government on Monday launched the ‘Delhi Ko Kude Se Azadi-Swachhta Abhiyan 2026’, a citywide campaign that will run till October 2, with a monthly reward of up to Rs.1 crore for the cleanest municipal ward.

Launching the campaign at the MCD headquarters, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the drive aims to strengthen sanitation, scientific waste management and cleanliness of public spaces while encouraging citizens, RWAs, market associations, educational institutions and voluntary organisations to actively participate.

Announcing a year-long ward-level cleanliness competition, Gupta said the best-performing ward each month would receive Rs.1 crore in Chief Minister’s Development Fund (CMDf) assistance, while consistently performing wards could earn incentives of up to Rs.12 crore over a year.

The rankings will be based on independent assessments, official reports and public complaints, including those received through social media. Wards where garbage-related complaints are found may face disqualification.

“Cleanliness is not the responsibility of any one department or agency; it is a shared responsibility



“CAMPAIGN INCLUDES SPL SANITATION DRIVES IN JJ CLUSTERS, PUBLIC TOILETS, PARKS, HOSPS AND GOVT SCHOOLS. THE GOVERNMENT ALSO ANNOUNCED THE DEPLOYMENT OF 70 MECHANICAL ROAD SWEEPERS

of every citizen,” the chief minister said. She added that the objective was “not merely to run cleanliness drives, but to make cleanliness a part of citizens’ daily behaviour and lifestyle.”

The campaign includes special sanitation drives in JJ clusters, public toilets, parks, hospitals and government schools.

The government also announced the deployment of 70 mechanical road sweepers, additional litter-picker vehicles for every ward and 125 secondary collection centres for construction and demolition waste.

Emphasising scientific waste management, Gupta highlighted the four pillars of the campaign, collection, cleaning, con-

version and circular economy, stressing segregation at source and converting waste into useful resources.

Union Minister of State Harsh Malhotra said, “‘Delhi Ko Kude Se Azadi’ is not limited to sanitation; it is an effort to make cleanliness a part of people’s thinking and behaviour.”

Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood described the campaign as “an effort to change the face of Delhi, citizens’ habits and their approach to cleanliness,” while Mayor Praveesh Wahi said “improved coordination between the Delhi government and the MCD would strengthen waste management and sanitation across the capital.”

Delhi introduces single-window, time-bound licensing system for cinema halls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

The Delhi government on Monday notified a new Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for issuing, renewing and inspecting cinematograph licences, replacing the decades-old multi-NOC system with a single-window, time-bound mechanism to simplify licensing for cinema halls and multiplexes.

Under the new system, separate no-objection certificates from departments such as Delhi Police, Fire Department, MCD, Delhi Jal Board, Health Department and power utilities have been scrapped. Instead, a District Inspection Committee (DIC) will conduct a joint inspection and upload an integrated, e-signed and geo-tagged verification report on the e-District portal.

The final decision will be taken by the District Licensing Committee (DLC) headed by the Deputy Commissioner (Revenue)/District Magistrate.

The SOP sets timelines of seven days for scrutiny, 45 days for inspection and 30 days for licensing, with automatic approval if compliant applications face delays.

AUGUST 20 Water supply to be hit in parts of West Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Water supply will remain disrupted in several parts of West Delhi on August 20 as the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) undertakes renovation and repair of a 1100-mm diameter header valve of the Khyala main installed at CWP-1, HP-1.

According to the DJB, water supply will either remain unavailable or be available at low pressure from 10 am to 4 pm on Thursday.

Areas likely to be affected include the com-

mand areas of Naraina Cantonment BPS/UGR, covering Inder Puri, Maya Puri, Toda Pur Village, Naraina Village, Naraina Vihar, Krishni Kunj, Mansarovar Garden, MES, as well as the command areas of Kirti Nagar UGR, HMP Colony, Punjabi Bagh UGR and adjoining localities.

DJB advised residents to store water ahead of the six-hour disruption. Tankers will be available on request, with emergency control rooms providing assistance.

Lakshmi Yojana: Ineligible beneficiaries to face aid stoppage and recovery of dues

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Beneficiaries of the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana found ineligible at any stage will have their financial assistance discontinued, may be tried for fraud, and will be made to return the disbursed money, the scheme’s guidelines stipulate.

The provision is part of the detailed guidelines notified by the Delhi government’s Women and Child Development Department for the scheme, which came into effect from August 1.

The Delhi Lakshmi Yojana provides financial assistance of Rs 2,500 per month to eligible women aged between 21 and 60 from low-income families in the national capital.

According to the notification, if a beneficiary is found ineligible at any point, the government will stop the financial assistance immediately and initiate recovery of the amount already released. Legal or administrative action for fraud will be undertaken where applicable.

“IF THE AMOUNT REMAINS UNCLAIMED FOR TWO YES FROM THE DATE OF DEATH, IT WILL REVERT TO THE GOVERNMENT ACCOUNT

In case of the death of the beneficiary, the amount being disbursed into the beneficiary’s Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) wallet will be stopped immediately. The money accrued in her Recurring Deposit (RD)

account, including interest, will be transferred to her legal heir.

If the amount remains unclaimed for two years from the date of death, it will revert to the government account, guidelines state. Under the scheme, by default, Rs 1,500 of the scheme money will be credited into an RD or Fixed Deposit account, with a lock-in period till July 31, 2029, and the remaining sum will go the beneficiary’s bank account linked with a CBDC wallet.

Alternatively, the entire Rs 2,500 monthly assis-

tance can be credited to an RD or FD account, also with a lock-in period till July 31, 2029, if the woman chooses so.

The CBDC wallet will restrict spending on alcohol, tobacco, narcotics, gambling and other items on the government’s negative list.

Eligible applicants must be Delhi voters, the eldest eligible woman in their family, with annual household income below Rs 2.5 lakh. Exclusions include government employees, pensioners, taxpayers and four-wheeler owners.

Delhi govt plans 300 new MBBS seats

Seeks to create a larger pool of doctors, specialists, super-specialists...

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

The Delhi government has unveiled a roadmap to significantly expand medical education in the capital by adding 300 undergraduate (MBBS) seats, 103 postgraduate (PG) and Diplomate of National Board (DNB) seats, and five fellowship seats across government medical institutions, subject to regulatory approvals.

According to the Health

Department, the expansion aims to address the shortage of doctors and specialists in government hospitals while strengthening the city’s healthcare infrastructure through a phased approach involving new medical colleges, expansion of existing institutions and enhanced post-graduate training.

As part of the plan, two under-construction medical colleges attached to Indira Gandhi Hospital, Dwarka, and Guru Gobind

“MIN PANKAJ KUMAR SINGH SAID THE INITIATIVE WAS AIMED AT CREATING A ROBUST HEALTHCARE WORKFORCE...

Singh Hospital will each offer 150 MBBS seats, adding 300 undergraduate seats. The government also proposes to increase MBBS intake at Dr. B.S.A.

Medical College and Hospital from 125 to 200 seats, while Maulana Azad Institute of Dental Sciences (MAIDS) will raise its BDS intake from 50 to 70 seats.

The roadmap includes 103 additional PG and DNB seats across institutions, including Dr. B.S.A. Medical College, Maulana Azad Medical College (MAMC), Indira Gandhi Medical College, GTB Hospital, UCMS, Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital, Bhagwan Mahavir Hospital and Delhi State

Cancer Institute. Another five fellowship seats have been proposed at GTB Hospital and Delhi State Cancer Institute to strengthen advanced medical training.

Health Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh said the initiative was aimed at creating a robust healthcare workforce for the future.

The minister said phased expansion would build a trained healthcare workforce, with adequate infrastructure and faculty, subject to NMC approvals.

Delhi, Nigeria eye stronger farm ties

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Delhi Minister Kapil Mishra on Monday met Nigeria’s Minister of State for Agriculture and Food Security, Dr. Aliyu Sabi Abdullahi, at the Delhi Secretariat to explore cooperation in agriculture, farmers’ welfare and food security.

The meeting focused on agricultural development, marketing of farm produce and ways to strengthen food security through better management and technology. Officials of

the Delhi government’s Development Department briefed the Nigerian delegation on the capital’s agricultural sector and various state and Central government schemes aimed at supporting farmers.

The Delhi Agricultural Marketing Board briefed the Nigerian delegation on the mandi system and agricultural supply chains. Both sides discussed technology, farmer welfare, food security and stronger market systems, while exploring continued knowledge-sharing.

FIVE LAKH PEOPLE AFFECTED SO FAR

North Odisha flood situation grim, IMD forecast more rains till Aug 18

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bhubaneswar, August 17

The flood situation in north Odisha districts, which has affected five lakh people, remained grim on Monday even as the IMD has forecast more rains after the low-pressure system formed in the Bay of Bengal intensified into a depression, officials said.

Keeping in view the gravity of the situation, Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi is likely to undertake an on-the-spot assessment of the calamity in the worst-hit Bhadrak and Jajpur districts later during the day, the CMO said.

It said more than 2.37 lakh people have been evacuated to safety and sheltered in nearly 300 relief camps on river embankments and also in schools.

The state government has cancelled leave for employees, and schools and educational institutions remained closed for the day due to inclement weather.

The IMD cautioned fishermen and advised them not to venture into the sea in the North Bay of Bengal and along the coasts of West Bengal, Bangladesh, Odisha and north Andhra



A truck lies overturned in a ditch after a newly constructed stretch of NH-53 caved in due to heavy rains, in Kendrapara, Odisha

KEY POINTS

- » CMO said more than 2.37 lakh people have been evacuated to safety and sheltered in nearly 300 relief camps on river embankments and also in schools
- » The state government has cancelled leave for employees, and schools and educational institutions remained closed for the day due to inclement weather

Pradesh coasts till August 18. The sea condition is very likely to be rough due to the impact of the depression, it said

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) National Bulletin noted that based on the 5.30 am situation, Sunday's well-

marked low-pressure area over northwest Bay of Bengal and adjoining West Bengal-north Odisha coasts moved nearly northwards and concentrated into a depression.

"The system at 5.30 am lay over coastal West Bengal and adjoining areas of Bangladesh and northwest at about 80 km west-southwest of Satkhira (Bangladesh), 160 km southeast of Bankura (West Bengal), and 180 km northeast of Balasore (Odisha)," it said.

BJP's 2029 team takes shape with 3 former...

Continued from Page 1
Former MP Harish Dwivedi are among the other new faces in the general secretaries' team.

The number of national vice-presidents has been increased to 13 from 11, with nine new faces. Former Rajasthan chief minister Vasundhara Raje Scindia, Baijayant Panda, Rekha Verma and Tariq Mansoor have been retained. Lok Sabha MP D Purandeshwari and former Uttarakhand chief minister Tirath Singh Rawat are among those appointed to the post.

Former Aligarh Muslim University vice-chancellor Tariq Mansoor has been retained as a vice-president, while former Punjab finance minister Manpreet Singh Badal has also been appointed to the post. Other new vice-presidents include Varshaben Narendrabhai Doshi, Bharti Pravin Pawar, Sardar Manpreet Singh Badal, Lal Singh Arya, M Nagaraja and Madhuchandra Kar.

The BJP has 16 national secretaries in its new team, compared with 11 earlier. Fourteen of the 16 are new faces, including Kavita Patidar, K Surendran, Sandeep Pathak, Manoj Tigga, Bhola Singh, Pradip Varma, Jagdish Ishwarbhai Patel, Phangnon Konyak, Sangeeta Yadav, M Venkateshan, Siddharth

Shambhu, Swadesh Singh, Mriganka Deo Barman, Rohan Gupta and Jai Prakash.

Anil Antony, son of Congress veteran A K Antony, has been retained as a national secretary.

Anil Baluni, the Lok Sabha MP from Uttarakhand, has been retained as the party's media in-charge. He will be assisted by three new media co-convenors, Ashish Usha Agrawal, Pradeep Bhandari and Siddharth Yadav. Priti Gandhi, Shivanand Dwivedi, Alok Bhatt and Arun Yadav have been appointed social media co-convenors.

The party has removed Amit Malaviya as head of its IT department and appointed Deepak Mhaskey from Chhattisgarh in his place. Tarun Chugh, a BJP Rajya Sabha MP, has been appointed central office in-charge, replacing Rajya Sabha MP Arun Singh.

The party has also replaced all its national morcha presidents, with Nabin stressing the importance of the BJP's frontal organisations. Hemang Joshi from Gujarat has been appointed Yuva Morcha president, replacing BJP MP Tejasvi Surya. Roop Kumari Choudhary from Chhattisgarh will head Mahila Morcha, replacing Vanathi Srinivasan, while Amarpal Maurya from Uttar Pradesh

has been appointed OBC Morcha president in place of Rajya Sabha MP K Laxman.

Bansilal Gurjar from Madhya Pradesh has been appointed Kisan Morcha president, Shivesh Kumar Ram from Bihar will head SC Morcha, and Mannalal Rawat from Rajasthan has been named ST Morcha president. Kunwar Basit Ali from Uttar Pradesh has been appointed Minority Morcha president.

Of the 65 office-bearers announced on Monday, 51 are new. Six are below 40 years, 15 are aged between 40 and 49, and 21 fall in the 50-59 age group. The team includes 12 women and six leaders from minority communities, party sources said.

The BJP said the appointments provide representation from 23 states and Union territories and were made with the party's electoral preparations through 2029 in mind.

"Such balanced appointments empower the incoming national president's executive team to operate with a profound awareness of the nation's vast geographical landscape and regional nuances," the BJP said in a statement.

The party also said the North-East had been given special attention, with three regional leaders from Tripura, Assam and

Nagaland inducted into the national structure. The dedicated North-East Coordination Cell will continue to be headed by BJP MP Sambit Patra, who has also been retained as the party's north-east coordinator.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated the newly appointed office-bearers in a post on X.

"Congratulations to the newly appointed National Office Bearers of the BJP and those who have been given various responsibilities in the party. This newly appointed team brings together organisational experience, energy and grassroots connection. I am confident they will give their best in strengthening our party and focusing on public service. My best wishes to them," Modi said.

Goyal's appointment as national treasurer has also triggered speculation that he could be dropped from the Union Cabinet in a possible reshuffle, in line with the BJP's practice of "one person, one post" during the Modi-Amit Shah era.

The new organisational team, which combines experienced leaders with a large cohort of younger and first-time office-bearers, comes as the BJP prepares for a series of Assembly elections and the 2029 Lok Sabha polls.

From page 1

Jharkhand

The chief minister also announced an examination reforms committee headed by senior IAS officer Amitabh Kaushal. He said the government was concerned about the agitation and had already enacted the Jharkhand Competitive Examination Prevention and Redressal of Unfair Means in Recruitment Act to address irregularities.

Soren said the probe by the CID and a special investigation team had uncovered "several surprising factors" that could not be disclosed at present. He also alleged that several companies operating in Jharkhand appeared to be involved in a major examination racket.

The JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch, however, said the agitation would continue until the demand for a CBI probe was accepted. Candidates who cleared the JSSC-CGL and obtained government jobs also protested outside the Jharkhand Secretariat, claiming that about 2,000 employees could lose their jobs following the cancellation.

The agitation has been marked by hunger strikes, with six protesters continuing their fast on Monday. Devedra Mahto, who has been on hunger strike for 16 days over the alleged irregularities, said he would soon end his fast.

The protesters have been demanding a CBI investigation into recruitment examination irregularities and cancellation of the JSSC-CGL exam.

Rahul asset case

opportunity to be heard before the high court issued directions. It observed that although police do not need prior court permission to act when a cognisable offence is committed, a court issuing directions must follow the principles of natural justice.

The case originated from Shishir's petition seeking a CBI and ED probe into Gandhi's alleged assets. In May, the Allahabad High Court directed the agencies to verify the allegations. On July 20, the high court criticised the CBI's response and sought a fresh affidavit from a senior officer detailing the progress of the inquiry. It said the ED could proceed if its investigation uncovered material indi-

cating illegality.

The high court had fixed August 20 as the next hearing and kept the case records in sealed cover. It also gave the Union government four weeks to file counter affidavits involving the DoPT, Department of Revenue, Ministry of Corporate Affairs and SFIO.

Shishir has separately pursued a citizenship-related case against Gandhi before the Allahabad High Court.

Bihar temple

The devotees had gathered to offer water to Lord Shiva at the temple. Mondays during Shravan, the month considered sacred to Lord Shiva, draw large numbers of pilgrims.

The deceased were identified as Manmala Devi, Rinku Devi, Hemlata Devi, Lalita Devi, Savita Devi, Saroj Devi and Savitri Devi. The injured were taken to the nearest government hospital for treatment, the district magistrate said.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary expressed grief over the deaths and announced an ex gratia payment of Rs 4 lakh to the next of kin of each victim. He also directed officials to ensure prompt medical care for those injured.

The district administration has formed a three-member inquiry team to investigate the circumstances and causes of the stampede.

Govt adviser

oxygen in ethanol-blended petrol. This can cause older engines to run with too little fuel and at higher temperatures, the authors said. Ethanol-incompatible rubber seals can also deteriorate after prolonged exposure.

"Dismissing complaints outright would be a mistake because beneath the noise lies a real problem and a much larger question," they wrote in The Indian Express, while noting that the views expressed were personal.

They estimated E20's overall energy penalty at about 6 to 7 per cent because ethanol contains less energy than petrol. Tests in India and the US have found no evidence of increased engine wear in vehicles designed for E20.

The authors also cautioned against raising blending beyond E20 without assess-

ing its impact on food crops, water and emissions. Maize provides about half of India's ethanol feedstock, while grains account for nearly 67 per cent. They said maize competes with soybean, groundnut and mustard for farmland and could affect efforts to reduce edible-oil imports.

They recommended keeping blending at E20 for now, restoring E10, reviewing water-use and crop incentives, and allowing time for older vehicles to be retrofitted.

NTA axes

complaints identified anomalies in all three subjects and recommended fresh tests, saying the affected papers did not meet the required standards for a fair and error-free examination.

The English and Commerce papers will now be held on September 9, while Sociology will be conducted on September 10. The UGC-NET examination was conducted from June 22 to 30 across 87 subjects for junior research fellowship, eligibility for assistant professor posts and admission to PhD programmes.

The latest action follows criticism from opposition parties and student organisations, several of which protested in Delhi on Monday and called for wider demonstrations against the NTA. The National Students' Union of India, Students' Federation of India, All India Students' Association and Krantikari Yuva Sangathan were among those taking part. The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad also raised concerns, with its National General Secretary Virendra Singh Solanki saying students' future cannot be compromised and that the NTA must be held accountable.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi demanded accountability from the agency's leadership. He said the resignation of former Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan was "the first step, not the last" and called for the NTA leadership to be held responsible. The Aam Aadmi Party described the issue as a failure that had cost students time, money, mental peace and opportunities.

The government has announced structural changes alongside the immediate corrective action. Ten specialised leadership posts are being filled, including Chief Technology Officer, Chief Finance Offi-

cer, Chief Information Security Officer, General Manager for Test Security and General Manager for Research and Development and Psychometrics. Professionals from the private sector are also being brought in for areas such as cybersecurity, psychometrics and question-paper design.

Joshi has ordered a complete overhaul of the NTA's Confidential Operations architecture. The changes include strengthening secluded rooms, deploying air-gapped systems and enforcing device-deposit protocols. The minister has also instructed officials to ensure strict compliance with examination procedures and identify gaps that could lead to further errors.

The NTA has been directed to conduct a comprehensive audit of all examination processes and submit a report on corrective action. An agency source said its responsibility was not only to conduct examinations without errors but also to act when an anomaly was detected. "The task of an examination-conducting agency is not only to conduct error-free examinations, but also to act promptly and honestly whenever an anomaly is found," the source said.

Joshi said the review also covered wider reforms in school and higher education, with the government seeking a more responsive and future-ready education system.

Tarapith inferno

Minister Suwendu Adhikari expressed grief and assured all necessary support.

"Deeply pained by the extremely tragic incident involving the pilgrims who lost their lives in a fire at a hotel in Tarapith, Birbhum district," Adhikari said in a post on X.

He said the police and administration acted swiftly and rescued a substantial number of people, but "despite all efforts, the tragic loss of lives could not be avoided".

Adhikari said the Superintendent of Police, District Magistrate, local MLA Dhruva Saha and Minister of State for Fire Department, Koushik Chowdhury, were at the site supervising the rescue operations.

He said the state government had taken strict measures to ascertain the root

cause of the tragedy, and assured that those responsible would be punished according to the law.

Appropriate compensation for the victims would also be announced, the CM said.

The fire erupted around 4.30 am on the ground floor of the hotel, identified as New Bideshini, when most guests were asleep. The temple town was witnessing a major influx of devotees on the last Monday of the holy month of Shravan. Of the 43 people staying at the hotel, 34 were discharged after preliminary examination, officials said.

Five of the deceased were members of a family from Meghalaya, while four others were residents of Alipurduar who had travelled to Tarapith to offer prayers.

Several guests were trapped on the upper floors as smoke rapidly engulfed the building. Fire tenders were rushed to the spot and brought the blaze under control.

The injured were taken to Rampurhat Government Medical College and Hospital, with some suffering burns and others affected by asphyxiation.

Preliminary investigation suggested the fire may have started near the reception after an electrical component of the power supply system caught fire. However, officials said the exact cause was yet to be established. Decorative and fibre materials inside the hotel reportedly helped the flames spread rapidly.

PM Modi expressed condolences to the bereaved families and announced the ex-gratia from the Prime Minister's National Relief Fund. Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari also expressed grief and assured all necessary support, saying strict action would be taken against those responsible.

Minister of State for Fire and Emergency Services Koushik Chowdhury said: "A detailed investigation will be conducted, and we will take stern action against those involved."

Birbhum Superintendent of Police Vidit Raj Bhundesh said the son of the hotel owner had been detained. He added: "The back gate was closed; if it had been open, more people might have been able to escape."

He also said the terrace door was closed and made of plywood, preventing smoke

from escaping. A forensic team was called in to examine the site.

Survivors recounted the horror. A Kolkata woman who escaped said: "Suddenly, the entire hotel was engulfed in smoke. We could not breathe, and it was hard to find an escape route." Guest Tapanjyoti Mondal said he was trapped with his wife and two children for nearly 45 minutes.

"We could not come out of the door because of the blaze. Since the room had no window, they escaped through an opening near the bathroom ceiling," he said.

Former chief minister Mamata Banerjee and TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee also expressed grief over the tragedy, praying for the victims and speedy recovery of those injured, while urging the administration to ensure immediate relief and support to affected families.

The Birbhum district administration has ordered a special audit of electrical installations and fire-fighting arrangements in hotels, lodges, guest houses and homestays across Tarapith ahead of the Kaushiki Amavasya festival, expected to draw a large number of pilgrims. Meanwhile, grief has gripped Alipurduar after four residents died in the tragedy. They had travelled to Tarapith for prayers.

The elder brother of one of the deceased, Subir Saha, said the family had last spoken to him on Sunday night.

"This morning, we suddenly received horrific news," he said. Former councillor and Subir's friend Parthapratim Ghosh said: "It is an extremely tragic incident... The death of these people from Alipurduar is deeply heartbreaking."Russia hits

Indian tycoon's

Sobyanin said about 600 drones were detected heading towards the capital, with a third destroyed over the Moscow region. At least six people were killed across Russia. An 83-year-old man died when a drone struck a home near Moscow, while five people were killed in Rostov region.

In Ukraine, strikes also killed people in Kryvyi Rih, Zaporizhzhia, Sumy and Donetsk. Six were wounded in Kyiv, where fires damaged a major book market.

Zelensky said Ukraine had faced more than 1,550 drones, 1,560 guided bombs and 62 missiles over the past week. Russia said it targeted the steel plant and military-industrial facilities in Kyiv.

AGENCIES

India leases

The contract was signed at Kartavya Bhawan-2 in New Delhi in the presence of Additional Secretary and Director General (Acquisition), Department of Defence, A Anbarasu.

The Indian Ocean Region is strategically important for India as a major route for global maritime trade and energy supplies. The region has also witnessed increased naval activity and a growing presence of extra-regional players, making continuous surveillance and maritime domain awareness increasingly important for India.

The MQ-9B Sea Guardian is a HALE remotely piloted aircraft designed for intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance (ISR) missions. Equipped with advanced sensors, payloads and surveillance systems, it can undertake prolonged missions over large maritime areas.

According to the Defence Ministry, the systems will enhance the Navy's Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA) and provide persistent ISR capabilities. They will help the Navy monitor ship movements and track developments of security significance across the IOR.

The two Sea Guardians will also supplement the Navy's existing surveillance assets, including maritime patrol aircraft, surface ships, satellites and other intelligence-gathering platforms. Their long endurance and advanced sensors are expected to strengthen the Navy's ability to maintain a comprehensive picture of activities across the maritime domain.

The lease arrangement will also allow the Navy to gain operational experience with advanced unmanned aerial surveillance technology while addressing its immediate maritime surveillance requirements.

The Defence Ministry said the acquisition would strengthen India's ability to track and respond to developments in the IOR and support the Navy's efforts to maintain a continuous and comprehensive maritime picture.

MP0ST

Briefs

‘BLOs bedrock of democracy’

PATNA: Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar on Monday described booth-level officers (BLOs) as the “bedrock of democracy”, who ensure that eligible electors get their voter ID cards made.

Kumar made the remarks after meeting BLOs in Bihar’s Nalanda district. “BLOs are the bedrock of democracy. They go to every voter’s home and, in a transparent manner, ensure that eligible electors get their voter ID cards made,” he told reporters on the sidelines of a conference here.

‘Restore AAP’s FB & Insta accounts’

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday ordered the restoration of the Instagram and Facebook accounts of the Aam Aadmi Party’s Gujarat unit.

A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe passed the order on an interim application filed by AAP Gujarat seeking restoration of its Facebook and Instagram accounts.

CM: Bihar to survey 44 mineral blocks

PATNA: Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Monday said the state government will survey 44 mineral blocks and work towards operationalising them within nine months, asserting that the resources would be harnessed for public welfare and the state’s development.

Athawale hints at Cabinet expansion

NAGPUR: Union minister Ramdas Athawale on Monday said a Union Cabinet reshuffle could take place “very soon,” while extending an offer to eight NCP (SP) MPs to join the NDA government if their party supreme declines to join the ruling alliance.

Throwing an olive branch at the Sharad Pawar-led NCP (SP) MPs, the Republican Party of India (A) chief urged the opposition party to bridge ideological differences and join the ruling National Democratic Alliance (NDA) to bolster development efforts.

T’gana SIR: 73L names out of draft rolls

HYDERABAD: As many as 73 lakh names have not been included in Telangana’s draft electoral rolls, while another 92 lakh electors will be issued notices over anomalies or failure to establish a link with the 2002 rolls during the ongoing SIR.

The draft electoral rolls were published on Monday following the enumeration phase held from June 25 to August 10.

BHARATIYA JANATA PARTY’S NEW NATIONAL TEAM

Now 12 women, 6 leaders from minority communities added

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 17

The BJP on Monday named as many as 12 women, including former Union minister Smriti Irani, and six leaders from minority communities in its new national team under party president Nitin Nabin.

The party leaders described the newly constituted team of national office bearers as a strategic blend of seasoned administrative and organisational experience, youthfulness, geographic diversity and comprehensive social inclusion.

Ten experienced women leaders from various regions of the country have been appointed among a total of 65 office bearers.

The team has 51 new members. Six members are below 40 years, 15 are in the 40-49 years age group, and 21 are in the 50-59 years age group. Party sources stressed that the revamp was done keeping in mind the BJP’s preparations for the Assembly polls up to 2029 and the next general elections.

Besides Irani, who has been made national general secretary, former Rajasthan CM Vasundhara Raje Scindia, former Union minister D Purandeshwari and ex-NCW chief Rekha Verma are vice-presidents. Kavita Patidar and San-



Vasundhara Raje Scindia and Smriti Irani

CLOSER LOOK

- » The team has 51 new members. Six members are below 40 years, 15 are in the 40-49 years age group, and 21 are in the 50-59 years age group
- » Kavita Patidar and Sangeeta Yadav have been appointed as national secretaries
- » - The BJP also appointed Deepak Mhaskey as the head of the BJP’s social media department, replacing Amit Malviya

geeta Yadav have been appointed as national secretaries.

Roop Kumari Choudhary has been appointed president of the BJP’s Mahila Morcha, while Priti Gandhi has been made a social media co-convenor.

The party said that to ensure that every major faith in India is respected and accommodated, the national office has given place to one Sikh member, two Christian members and one member each from Muslim, Jain and Parsi communities.

The earlier team had eight women members and four leaders from minority communities.

Former Aligarh Mus-

lim University vice chancellor Prof Tariq Mansoor has been appointed national vice president. Kunwar Basit Ali has been appointed president of the Minority Morcha.

Anil Antony, the son of Congress veteran A K Antony, has been retained as a national secretary. Former Punjab finance minister Manpreet Singh Badal has been appointed BJP national vice-president.

The party said the new appointments ensure widespread representation, accommodating voices from 23 states and Union territories across the country.

“Such balanced appointments empower

the incoming national president’s executive team to operate with a profound awareness of the nation’s vast geographical landscape and regional nuances,” the BJP said in a statement.

The party highlighted that a special focus has been placed on the North-East region, which has been given distinct prominence through the appointment of three regional leaders from Tripura, Assam and Nagaland and the continuation of a dedicated North-East Coordination Cell, which will be headed by Sambit Patra.

Furthermore, the committee has four tribal representatives from West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and the North-East, two of whom are women. Additionally, the Scheduled Castes (SC) are represented by three members from Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Madhya Pradesh.

The BJP also appointed Deepak Mhaskey, an academic and former member of the board of Engineers India Limited, as the head of the BJP’s social media department, replacing Amit Malviya, who had been steering the party’s social media outreach for 11 years.

Malviya congratulated his successor, who also had a stint as a chemistry professor in Chhattisgarh.

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, August 17

Uttar Pradesh has secured a sizeable presence in BJP president Nitin Nabin’s new national team, with eight leaders from the state finding places in key organisational positions, including two national vice presidents, two general secretaries, two national secretaries and the presidents of the party’s OBC and Minority Morchas.

The composition gives Uttar Pradesh representation across several layers of the BJP’s national organisation. More significantly, the party has retained its focus on social and community outreach by handing the national presidency of both the OBC Morcha and Minority Morcha to leaders from the state.

Senior party leader Amar Pal Maurya has been appointed national president of the OBC Morcha, while Kunwar Basit Ali, who was state chief of Minority



BJP chief Nitin Nabin

Morcha, has been made national president of the Minority Morcha.

The other prominent UP faces in the Lok Sabha include former Union minister Smriti Irani and former MP Harish Dwivedi, both of whom have been appointed national general secretaries.

Irani, who represented Amethi in the Lok Sabha from 2019 to 2024, had emerged as one of the BJP’s most prominent national leaders during her tenure as a Union minister. Her appointment as national general secretary gives her a direct organisational role at a time when the BJP

is preparing for another round of electoral battles in the politically crucial Hindi heartland.

Harish Dwivedi, a former BJP MP from Basti, has also been elevated to the post of national general secretary.

The state has also got two national vice presidents in Rekha Verma and Tariq Mansoor. Verma, a former BJP MP from Dhaurahra, has been retained in a senior national organisational role. Mansoor, former vice chancellor of Aligarh Muslim University and a member of the BJP’s national leadership, has also been appointed national vice president.

Mansoor’s appointment assumes importance in the context of the BJP’s continuing efforts to expand its outreach among Muslims.

His presence in the national team, alongside Basit Ali’s appointment as Minority Morcha president, gives UP two senior organisational faces associated with the party’s minority outreach.

India, Armenia explore new avenues

New Delhi, August 17

India and Armenia on Monday explored new avenues to bolster defence cooperation, and reaffirmed their shared commitment to deepening and elevating the India-Armenia defence partnership,” the Indian defence ministry said in a post on X.

Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, who is visiting Armenia, called on the country’s defence minister, Suren Papikyan, in Yerevan on Monday.

“The two sides explored new avenues to further strengthen bilateral defence cooperation, reaffirming their shared commitment to deepening and elevating the India-Armenia defence partnership,” the Indian defence ministry said in a post on X.

It also shared some photos of the meeting in the Armenian capital.

Defence Secretary Singh reached Yerevan on August

16 for a two-day visit. On arrival, he was received by India’s ambassador to Armenia and senior representatives of the Armenian defence ministry.

“During the visit, he (Singh) will engage with the Armenian leadership to chart the course of future India-Armenia defence and strategic cooperation,” the defence ministry had said in a post on X on Sunday.

Farming is more than a livelihood: Chhattisgarh CM

Raipur, August 17

Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai on Monday returned to his farming roots, ploughing a field with a pair of bullocks in his native village Bagiya in Jashpur district.

Sai reached the field early in the morning and took up the plough to carry out the traditional biyasi, a farming practice associated with paddy cultivation.

The moment brought back memories of his childhood and his close association with agriculture.

Chief Minister said, “Coming from a farming family, agriculture has never been just a means of livelihood for me. It is a way of life and a value I have grown up with.”

CM said spending time in his village and fields gave him a sense of peace and renewed energy.

He recalled how working on the land from an early age had shaped his understanding of hard



Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai ploughing a field, in Jashpur district, Monday MPOST

work, respect for labour and the need to remain connected with nature and one’s roots.

Chief Minister said agriculture remains central to Chhattisgarh’s identity, with the state’s rural life, traditions and festivals closely linked to farming. Generations of farmers have contributed to the state’s prosperity through their hard work, he said.

He also stressed the need to remain connected with traditional practices

even as the state moves towards modernisation. Farming, he said, teaches patience, hard work and sensitivity towards nature, while farmers contribute to both society and the state’s economy through their labour.

“Chhattisgarh’s soil, its rich farming traditions and its hardworking farmers have always been close to my heart. The prosperity of farmers and agriculture is a strong foundation for the prosperity of the state,” Sai said.

Shehzad Poonawalla resigns from BJP

Submits resignation to party chief

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 17

BJP national spokesperson Shehzad Poonawalla on Monday said he has resigned from all positions and primary membership of the party.

Poonawalla stated that he has submitted his resignation letter to BJP national president Nitin Nabin, requesting that he accept it.

He also posted his resignation letter on X, which stated that he had written to Nabin, offering “to resign unconditionally” from all positions and primary membership of the BJP on July 30 due to “pressing financial and personal circumstances.”

In his letter to Nabin, Poonawalla expressed how moved he was by the party’s reluctance to accept his resignation promptly, as they requested him to reconsider his decision.

“But after long and

hard contemplation, I have arrived at a final decision that I would like to press for relieving me from my role as National Spokesperson and active primary membership of the BJP. The events of the last few days, courtesy certain individuals about whom I have told you in great detail, have forced me to reinforce and stand by my earlier decision”, he added.

On July 31, Poonawalla updated his bio on X, omitting any mention of the BJP, which sparked speculation about his potential departure from the party. But there was no official confirmation from the party at that time. In his latest resignation letter Poonawalla said, “As stated earlier, due to pressing emergency financial and personal circumstances, I will move into the private sector, but wherever possible and in whatever format possible, I will continue to support the vision and work of PM Modi and the BJP.

Prashant Kishor takes oath as Bihar MLA

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Patna, August 17

Jan Suraj party founder Prashant Kishor took oath as Bankipur MLA at the Bihar Legislative Assembly in the presence of Speaker Prem Kumar on Monday.

Talking to reporters after taking the oath, he said, “To be a member of the House in which people like Krishna Sinha, Karpoori Thakur, Anugrah Narayan Sinha, Nitish Kumar, Lalu Prasad Yadav, Kedar Pandey, Ram Vilas Paswan, and Sushil Kumar Modi served, is a matter of pride for me.”

He said it was also “a big responsibility” for him to work on the lines of “hundreds of MLAs who dedicated the valuable years of their lives to the betterment of society and the state”. Kishor made a historic electoral debut on August 3, winning the bypoll for Bihar’s prestigious Bankipur Assembly constituency.

AFTER CJP ANNOUNCES TO CONDUCT SCHOOL INSPECTION

Rajasthan govt restricts entry of outsiders in govt schools

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Jaipur, August 17

The Rajasthan govt has restricted the entry of outsiders into govt schools without prior permission of the principal and barred photography and videography without written approval, a move which came after the CJP announced it would inspect schools in the state that are in a “poor” condition.

The govt order issued on Sunday evening also comes in the backdrop of protests in some government schools across the state over alleged lack of amenities and short-

KEY POINTS

- » The government order issued also comes in the backdrop of protests in some govt schools across state over alleged lack of amenities and shortage of teachers
- » Education minister Madan Dilawar defended the order, saying it was aimed at protecting the privacy, safety and rights of minor students

age of teachers. Videos and reports of such demonstrations have been circulated in the media and on social media in recent weeks.

Rajasthan Education minister Madan Dilawar defended the order, saying it was aimed at protecting

the privacy, safety and rights of minor students and did not impose a blanket ban on visitors.

In a social media post on Sunday morning, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) co-convenor Ashutosh Ranka said the party would visit

schools in Rajasthan which are in a poor condition.

“So far, I have received requests from Jaipur, Ajmer, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Dholpur, Bharatpur, Kota, Barmer, and Hanumangarh in Rajasthan to inspect schools in poor condition. In these places, the administration is refusing to heed demands to fix the schools. I will be visiting all these locations over the next few days,” he had said.

Hours after the CJP post, the Director of Secondary Education Lalit Kumar issued a circular that stated that under the principle of “in loco parentis” (in the

place of a parent), it has a special responsibility to ensure the safety, dignity, privacy and welfare of children studying in government schools.

Citing Article 21 of the Constitution, a Supreme Court judgment on the right to privacy and guidelines of the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR), the department said the measures were aimed at ensuring a safe, protected and child-friendly environment in schools and safeguarding children against exploitation and invasion of privacy.

Under the directions, no

outsider, except a government official duly authorised for official duties, will be allowed to enter a school campus without prior permission of the principal or head of the institution.

Every visitor will also have to make an entry in the visitor register before entering the premises.

The circular issued on Sunday further says no outsider can enter classrooms, laboratories, libraries, hostels, playgrounds, toilets or areas where student activities are taking place without being accompanied by the principal, a teacher or an authorised school official.

Prez Murmu gives assent to Bill to renaming Kerala as Keralam

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 17

President Droupadi Murmu has given assent to a Bill to rename Kerala as Keralam, with the legislation now becoming a law.

The Lok Sabha passed the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026, on Tuesday, followed by the Rajya Sabha the next day.

In the Rajya Sabha, Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai said the Kerala Assembly passed a resolution in 2024, urging the Centre to bring a law to change the name of the state to Keralam.

“The Bill provides that the State of Kerala will be known as the State of Keralam, and hence there is a proposal to rename the State of Kerala to Keralam,” he said.

The Kerala government had forwarded a resolution passed by the state Assembly regarding the name change to the Centre in June 2024.

Subsequently, President Murmu referred the Bill to the state legislature for its views, following which the Assembly adopted a unanimous resolution agreeing with the Bill.

The Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill provides for the alteration of the state’s name and contains necessary amendments to the Constitution and consequential provisions, according to the Bill’s statement of objects and reasons.

Amendments will be made in the First Schedule to the Constitution by modifying the name of Kerala as Keralam in accordance with Article 3 of the Constitution.

MORE THAN 200 ‘OPERATIVES’ ARRESTED

Govt destroyed ISI-backed Shahzad Bhatti network ahead of I-Day: HM

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 17

Security agencies have launched a massive crack-down on the ISI-backed Shahzad Bhatti network ahead of Independence Day, detaining 253 people and thwarting plots of subversion and terrorism across the country in a multi-state operation.

Security agencies cracked down on the Pakistan-based network, citing involvement in grenade, IED and petrol bomb attacks, targeted killings and espionage, in an intelligence-led operation on August 12.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Monday said that over 200 operatives of the ISI-backed terror group were arrested. Substantial recoveries, including IEDs, grenades bearing Pakistan Ordnance Factory markings, pistols, live cartridges, and CCTV cameras used for espionage, were made from the ISI-funded group, he said.

In a post on ‘X’, he said: “Modi government destroyed the ISI-backed terror group Shahzad Bhatti Network ahead of Independence Day and thwarted its plans for subversive attacks by arresting more than 200 operatives.” “Indian security forces



Delhi Police Special Cell with six arrested in connection with Shahzad Bhatti network on 6 July, 2026

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Substantial recoveries, including IEDs, grenades bearing Pakistan Ordnance Factory markings, pistols, live cartridges, and CCTV cameras used for espionage, were made from the ISI-funded group
- » The Pakistan-based terror syndicate linked to grenade, IED and petrol bomb attacks and targeted killings across India

ripped apart the network by launching coordinated operations across different locations in 14 states, upholding a brilliant example of India’s zero-tolerance towards terrorism,” he said. The network was involved in several terrorist activities, Shah said.

According to a government statement, the Shahzad Bhatti Network (SBN) is a Pakistan-based terror syndicate linked to grenade, IED and petrol bomb attacks and targeted killings across India.

The SBN has also been paying local conduits

to recce police, defence and religious sites, and to install CCTV cameras for espionage. The NIA is probing multiple cases against Bhatti, including an alleged link to the March 2025 grenade attack at the residence of social media influencer Roger Sandhu in Jalandhar, Punjab.

In April 2026, the NIA had chargesheeted Bhatti as an absconder, and one other accused in the case.

The anti-terror agency has further found that Bhatti had also masterminded the November 2025 explosion at the Women Police Station, Sirsa, Haryana and the Jan-

uary 2026 blast at Baldev Nagar police station in Ambala, Haryana.

In the Sirsa case, the NIA had chargesheeted nine individuals, including Bhatti and another Pakistan-based handler Sohail Ahmad alias Sohail Baloch, in May 2026. The Baldev Nagar police station case relates to a car bomb explosion, in which one arrested accused was found to have been in touch with Bhatti.

“To counter SBN-linked disruptions planned around Independence Day, a coordinated multi-state operation was carried out on August 12 using a real-time intelligence-sharing system with State Police forces,” the government statement said.

Over 200 arrests were made during the operation in 14 states, including Uttar Pradesh (62), Haryana (52), Delhi (51), Punjab (44), Rajasthan (15), Maharashtra (8), Uttarakhand (5), Karnataka, Gujarat and Bihar (3 each), and Telangana, Himachal Pradesh, J&K and Kerala (2 each) with fresh FIRs registered in Delhi and Karnataka.

“Cumulatively, over 80 FIRs and 200-plus arrests have been recorded against SBN under UAPA, BNS, the Arms Act, NDPS Act and Explosive Substances Act,” it said.

Suspected JeM operative held in UP’s Meerut

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, August 17

The Uttar Pradesh Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS) has arrested a 24-year-old Bihar man from a mosque in Meerut for his alleged links with Pakistan-based terror outfit Jaish-e-Mohammed, officials said Monday.

The accused, Mohamad Zafar, a resident of Purnia district, had obtained a Maulvi degree from a madrasa in Meerut in 2022. He returned to the city around two months ago and was arrested from a mosque on Sunday.

According to the ATS, Zafar collected donations in the name of a madrasa and allegedly sent the money to Jaish-e-Mohammed in Pakistan. Investigators also found Pakistani jihadi WhatsApp groups on his phone and alleged evidence of his involvement in online activities related to jihad and establishing a caliphate.

The ATS alleged that Zafar was influenced by speeches and material glorifying jihad and Jaish chief Masood Azhar. He allegedly shared jihadi content on social media and remained in contact with suspected Pakistani operatives. Investigators also suspect that he transferred money using USDT cryptocurrency and sought details of a Binance account at a handler’s direction.

SC to SIT: Conclude Ram Temple case probe expeditiously

Apex Court seeks status report

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 17

The Supreme Court on Monday asked a court-appointed Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya to complete its investigation expeditiously and take it to a logical conclusion.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also directed the SIT to file a status report in a sealed cover on the progress made in the investigation.

“The SIT, which includes a forensic auditor, will submit its status report to the Supreme Court in a sealed cover. The report will be first perused by us and seen if we have to release it to all the parties,” it said. The bench also asked the SIT to consider objectively any suggestions made by the different litigants before the court for qualitative improvement of the investigation and its transparency.

It permitted the petitioners seeking a court-monitored investigation by an independent agency or the CBI, and other public-spirited persons to submit suggestions to the office of the Solicitor General on

any aspect that should be probed by the SIT in connection with the allegations of donations theft.

It said the office of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta will forward the suggestions to the SIT, which would be considered objectively. “We also permit the petitioners or any other bona fide public-spirited person to give their suggestions to the office of the Solicitor General with respect to the aspects that may be required to be thoroughly investigated by the SIT. The office of the Solicitor General shall forward the suggestions to the SIT. We have no reason to doubt that the same shall be objectively considered,” it ordered.

The bench said after examining the report of the SIT, the court may issue certain directions for reforms in the management of donations made by the devotees visiting the Ram temple.

Briefs

Assam flood situation improves

GUWAHATI: The flood situation in Assam improved on Monday, even as one more person died and around 32,000 people still reeled under the deluge across four districts, officials said.

According to the ASDMA, one person drowned in flood waters in Sivasagar district, pushing the toll in this year’s deluge to 105. Over 31,900 people have been affected in multiple districts.

PRTC to get 100 new midi buses

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Transport Minister Harpal Singh Cheema on Monday announced that 100 ‘PRTC JUNIOR’ buses will join the PRTC fleet by mid-September to improve public transport connectivity in rural areas.

The fully-built midi buses are being manufactured and supplied by Eicher.

Judge awards death penalty to 22...

MUZAFFARNAGAR: The court of Additional District and Sessions Judge Ravi Kumar Diwakar has sentenced 22 people to death in 10 cases over the past four months, a government lawyer said on Monday.

The cases include the murder of a lawyer and a home guard, highway robbery and other killings. The court recently awarded death sentences to four in a 2014 murder case.

CM Saini: Haryana ‘fast-tracks’ key industrial, logistics projects

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 17

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday said the state government was expediting major industrial and logistics projects to establish Haryana as a leading manufacturing hub in the country.

Saini made the remarks while participating through video conferencing in the third meeting of the Apex Monitoring Authority of the National Industrial Corridor Development and Implementation Trust, chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman. Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal, chief ministers and senior officials also attended the meeting.

Saini reviewed the progress of the Integrated Multi-Modal Logistics Hub (IMLH) at Nangal Chaudhary and the Hisar Integrated Manufacturing



Haryana CM Nayab Saini virtually attends the 3rd meeting of the Apex Monitoring Authority, chaired by Union Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman

Cluster (IMC). He said land approval, connectivity and infrastructure works were progressing rapidly.

The Chief Minister said land acquisition for Phase-I of the Nangal Chaudhary logistics hub was being expedited and would be completed shortly. He will visit the hub on August 23 and flag off the railway line. The railway yard

of the CWC IMLH will be operated by the Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC).

On the Hisar IMC, Saini said bids had been received for the Rs 707-crore EPC project for Phase-I infrastructure and were being evaluated. The EPC agency will be appointed shortly, while the master plan is targeted to be notified by August 31, 2026.

Canal diversion work for Phase-I has already been awarded, while NHAI has awarded the proposed double-loop interchange at Dhandur Junction on an EPC basis.

Saini said a proposal had also been sent to the Centre under the BHAVYA scheme for an industrial park on 108 acres in Ambala. Land acquisition is being advanced for other proposed Integrated Manufacturing Clusters, with land being acquired for 10 IMTs in Haryana.

VD Sharma, Patel and Arya from MP get key roles in BJP’s new national team

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, August 17

Three leaders from Madhya Pradesh – VD Sharma (Vishnu Datt Sharma), Gajendra Patel and Lal Singh Arya – have been assigned key organisational responsibilities in the BJP’s new national team announced by party president Nitin Nabin on Monday.

VD Sharma, a second-term Lok Sabha member from Khajuraho and former president of the MP BJP unit, has been appointed All Cells Coordinator (also referred to as National Coordinator of the Cell Cluster). Sharma, known for his organisational skills, will oversee the party’s various cells.

Gajendra Patel, a prominent Scheduled Tribe leader and second-term Lok Sabha member from Khargone, has been named National General Secre-



KAVITA PATIDAR, BANSILAL GURJAR AND ASHISH AGRAWAL FROM THE STATE SECURE BERTHS IN THE TEAM

tary. He joins a team of eight national general secretaries, including Smriti Irani, Vinod Tawde, Sunil Bansal, Biplob Kumar Deb, Satish Poonia, Harish Dwivedi and Sanjay Bhatia.

Lal Singh Arya has been appointed National Vice-President. A senior Dalit leader and former Minister of the State, Arya previously served as National



President of the BJP Scheduled Caste Morcha. He is among the 13 national vice-presidents in the new line-up.

The appointments form part of a broader reshuffle under Nabin, featuring a mix of experienced leaders and newer faces. Two leaders with links to Madhya Pradesh – Saudan Singh and Tarun Chugh, a Rajya Sabha MP from the state – have also been appointed Joint General Secretary (Organisation) and Central Office In-Charge, respectively.

Other leaders from the state who have been given national roles include Rajya



Sabha MP Kavita Patidar, who has been appointed National Secretary; Bansilal Gurjar, who has been named National President of the BJP Kisan Morcha; and Ashish Agrawal, who has been appointed Media Co-Convenor. The announcement indicates that six to eight leaders from the state have found a place in the national organisational set-up.

The changes take effect immediately. Nabin described the new team as a “blend of experience and energy” that would strengthen the organisation in pursuit of the vision of a “Viksit Bharat.”

REINFORCING THE HIMALAYAN BOND

Army chief Gen Seth’s Nepal visit carries strategic weight

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 17

Chief of Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth’s three-day visit to neighbouring Nepal, which started on Monday, is particularly timely in the context of Indian-Nepalese relations, with much more significance than the routine and formal elements of military diplomacy usually involve.

In view of the ongoing change in the strategic equation of the Himalayan subcontinent, Seth’s visit provides an excellent chance for New Delhi to consolidate one of the most lasting security relationships that it has.

While ostensibly focused on deepening defence cooperation between the two countries, General Seth’s trip



will undoubtedly open up the possibility for talks covering topics like border security, intelligence sharing, military training, disaster management and institutional cooperation. But underneath all these aspects of defence cooperation lies a more serious concern of how India and Nepal can sustain their longstanding military rela-

tionship against the backdrop of a fast-changing security environment in the region.

Experts feel that the Gorkha connection continues to be at the centre of this relationship. For many years now, the recruitment of Nepalese nationals in the Indian Army has acted as a special link between the two nations, forging not

KEY POINTS

- » Seth’s visit provides an excellent chance for New Delhi to consolidate one of the most lasting security relationships that it has
- » Experts feel that the Gorkha connection continues to be at the centre of this relationship

just military ties but also strong socio-institutional links. Now, given the unresolved issue of the recruitment of Nepali Gorkhas through the Agnipath scheme, this aspect has become an important part of the larger picture of the defence relationship. Thus, the visit by Gen Seth acquires special importance in this context.

In terms of the geopolitical environment, the engagement becomes even more significant. Nepal’s efforts to carefully tread on the delicate issue of maintaining a balanced relationship with India and China have started gaining strategic importance for India.

The traditional practice of conferring the honorary rank of General of the Nepali Army on the Indian Army chief adds another layer of symbolism to the visit, as it symbolises the trust and respect developed by the two militaries over the years and is a unique aspect of their defence relations. Hence, during the first day of his visit, General Seth, was conferred the honorary rank of General of the Nepali Army by Nepal President Ram Chandra Pau-

del in Kathmandu, which is rooted in a longstanding military tradition, symbolises mutual trust, professional camaraderie and the enduring strategic partnership between India and Nepal.

However, more importantly, the meeting of General Seth is occurring at a time when India is making efforts to enhance its relations with Nepal’s political, diplomatic, and military establishments. In this way, the visit of the Indian Army Chief could be a significant vehicle for strategic communication.

In the case of New Delhi, the overriding goal is obvious: ensuring that the long-standing military cooperation between India and Nepal is still relevant to the security issues of the 21st century.

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, August 17

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Monday flagged off 25 new Type-I electric bus services of the Himachal Road Transport Corporation (HRTC) for Mandi district, marking the second phase of EV induction in the state.

The government had earlier procured 297 Type-I electric buses, which are operating across several districts. Sukhu said the buses have a prescribed range of about 180 km at 80 per cent charge, while one bus on the Shimla-Chandigarh route covers around 270 km on a single charge. He said electric buses were saving HRTC about Rs 12-13 per km in energy costs compared to diesel buses.

EDITORIAL

Work Equation

India's latest employment numbers offer reason for cautious optimism. The unemployment rate for people aged 15 and above fell to 5.1 per cent in July, its lowest level in four months, from 5.5 per cent in June. Rural unemployment declined more sharply, from 5 per cent to 4.5 per cent, while labour force participation rose to 55.4 per cent. The worker population ratio also improved to 52.5 per cent. Female participation registered encouraging gains. These are important indicators for an economy that must find productive work for millions entering the labour market every year. Yet the numbers also underline why India's employment debate must now move beyond the unemployment rate itself.

The central question is increasingly not whether Indians are working, but what kind of work they are finding. A person engaged in poorly paid, irregular or involuntary self-employment is counted as employed, but that tells little about economic security. India continues to have a vast informal workforce without predictable wages, social security or meaningful protection against economic shocks. The challenge is therefore to convert economic growth into employment that raises household incomes and productivity. That requires sustained expansion of labour-intensive manufacturing, construction, tourism, logistics, textiles, food processing and modern services rather than relying excessively on a handful of capital-intensive sectors.

The fault line is particularly visible among the young. India's demographic advantage can become an economic liability if education produces aspirations faster than the economy produces suitable jobs. Graduates competing for limited government vacancies, young workers accepting jobs far below their qualifications and the growing dependence on gig work reveal a mismatch between education, skills and labour-market demand. Urban unemployment, meanwhile, edged up to 6.7 per cent in July from 6.6 per cent in June even as the national figure improved. This divergence deserves attention because India's continuing urbanisation will steadily move more job seekers towards cities.

Policy must consequently focus on the quality as much as the quantity of employment. Incentives for manufacturing should be judged partly by jobs created, especially for women and first-time workers. Apprenticeships need to become a mainstream bridge between education and employment. Small businesses require easier access to credit and fewer regulatory obstacles because they remain among India's largest potential employment generators. Greater female participation must also be supported through safer transport, affordable childcare and workplaces capable of retaining women.

A 5.1 per cent unemployment rate is welcome, but it cannot become an excuse for complacency. India's ambition is not merely to keep its population occupied. A rapidly growing economy must create work that provides decent wages, stability, skills and opportunities for advancement. The true measure of India's employment success will ultimately be not how many people have some work, but how many have good work.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Lasting Legacy

The death of filmmaker Raja Sen is a profound loss to Bengali cinema. A three-time National Award winner, Sen moved effortlessly across cinema, television and documentaries. From Damu and Atmiyo Swajan to his documentation of Bengal's cultural icons, his sensitive storytelling preserved a distinctive humanism that deserves lasting remembrance.

SUBHASIS CHOUDHARY,
KOLKATA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Hospitals Under Invasion

India's hospitals are attracting unprecedented amounts of private capital. But if healthcare becomes a mere investment, who will ultimately pay the price?

TALKING SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER IS A JOURNALIST & COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

India's hospitals are being invaded. Not by patients. Not by disease. But by capital. Over the past few years, some of the country's best-known hospital chains have moved into the hands of private equity, sovereign and pension funds and institutional investors. Manipal Health has just entered the stock market at a valuation of US \$9 billion (Rs 85,500 crore). KKR will soon acquire Medicovert's Indian hospital business for \$1.39 billion (Rs 13,200 crore). Healthcare deal-making is burning hot, hospital chains are consolidating and investors are pouring money into an industry whose prospects appear irresistible.

There is nothing inherently wrong with any of this. India desperately needs more hospitals and beds, better technology, stronger management and vastly greater healthcare capacity. Private capital can provide all of those things at a scale that the public system alone just cannot. ICRA estimates that 18 large hospital chains could add more than 34,000 beds between FY 2025-26 and FY 2029-30.

So, what then makes this wor-

thy of a discussion? It is the uncomfortable question of what happens when a hospital stops being primarily a healthcare institution and becomes a financial asset.

Follow the Money

The investment case is compelling. India has a huge and growing demand for healthcare, rising incomes, increasing insurance penetration and a chronic shortage of quality hospital capacity. The industry itself is fragmented, leaving plenty of room for consolidation and professionalisation. For investors, hospitals offer long-lived physical assets, recurring demand and opportunities to build large regional or national platforms.

For the patient, however, the equation is different. He does not walk into a hospital because healthcare is an attractive growth sector. He walks in because something has gone wrong with his body. Often badly. He may be frightened, vulnerable, financially stretched and completely dependent on people who know vastly more about medicine than he does. That makes healthcare unlike almost any other business.

A customer can walk out of a restaurant because the food is expensive. He can stop using a streaming service because the subscription has increased. But a patient cannot necessarily shop around when a heart attack, cancer diagnosis or emergency surgery has arrived at the front door. This extraordinary asymmetry of power is precisely why the 'financialization' of healthcare deserves scrutiny.

The New Logic

Private ownership does not necessarily mean worse healthcare. In many cases, the opposite may be true. Professional management can improve efficiency. Larger networks can negotiate better prices for equipment and medicines. Common systems can improve clinical processes. More capital can mean more beds, better diagnostics and newer technology.

But institutional capital comes with a different vocabulary. Mar-



Capital must serve healthcare, rather than calculating returns

WHEN PROFIT BECOMES THE ONLY MOTIVE, PATIENTS RISK BECOMING LESS THAN HUMAN BEINGS WHO NEED HEALING, TURNING INTO MERE NUMBERS ON THE BALANCE SHEET

gins. EBITDA. Capacity utilisation. Return on capital. Same-store growth. Acquisition multiples. Synergies. Exit valuations. None of these words is dirty. Investors are entitled to seek returns on capital. Hospital managements have a responsibility to remain financially sustainable. But somewhere inside that vocabulary sits a question that cannot be answered by an Excel spreadsheet: What happens when the price of treating a patient begins

to be influenced by the price investors expect from the institution?

We are not talking of the price of a room. Not the tariff for a procedure. Not the cost of an implant. The question is whether the financial logic of the institution can ever become more powerful than the clinical logic of the institution. That is where India needs to pay attention.

The Patient Problem

A hospital can become more efficient without becoming less humane. But efficiency can also become a euphemism for doing more with less, pushing utilisation higher and extracting greater returns from expensive infrastructure. The temptation is obvious. A hospital bed is an asset. An operating theatre is an asset. A diagnostic machine is an asset. A specialist is an enormously valuable asset.

And the patient? The patient is the reason all those assets exist. This distinction matters because healthcare has an uncomfortable economic characteristic: its success is measured by something business does not normally measure - a customer who no longer needs the service. That is not an argument

for inefficient hospitals or against profitability. It is a reminder that healthcare has a moral dimension that cannot be reduced to occupancy rates and margins.

India has already seen what happens when information asymmetry becomes extreme. Patients struggle to understand bills, procedures, packages, investigations and treatment alternatives. Insurance adds a new layer of complexity. The person least equipped to negotiate is often the person holding the largest bill. Now, add institutional investors to an already complicated relationship. And the question is not whether they will demand returns. Of course, they will. The question is how those returns are generated.

Line We Can't Cross

India is going to need tens of thousands of crores of rupees of investment in healthcare. There can be no defensible argument against it. The public system cannot carry the country's entire healthcare burden, and private capital can help fill an enormous gap. But money must come with guardrails.

We should welcome investors who build hospitals, expand capacity, bring technology and professionalise healthcare. We should be far less comfortable if the pursuit of returns begins to influence clinical decisions, inflate unnecessary costs or turn vulnerability into a business model. The test is not whether hospitals make money. The test is what happens to the patient while they do. India's hospitals may indeed need more capital. They may need bigger networks, deeper pockets and better management.

As the money pours in, we should remember one thing. A hospital is not just an asset with beds. It is an institution entrusted with human lives. If India forgets that distinction, the greatest danger will not be that our hospitals are owned by finance. It will be that finance begins to own the definition of healthcare itself.

Views expressed are personal

Pakistan's Terror Spiral

Rising terror attacks expose deep fractures within Pakistan's increasingly strained security architecture

REGIONAL FAULTLINES



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT

According to a series of reports in the Pakistani media, the country is facing a serious security crisis as terror violence registered a sharp rise in July 2026. During the deadly month, more than 112 security personnel were killed while confronting insurgent elements across Pakistan. The surge, alongside a persistent civilian death toll, underscores relentless cross-border infiltration, possibly from the western frontier. Compounding the crisis, hostile actors exploit internal safe havens by collaborating with groups including the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) and Baloch Liberation Army (BLA). Neutralising these sleeper cells demands a robust kinetic strategy. It is, however, unfathomable what Pakistan's intelligence set-up is doing to prevent the activities of sleeper cells and their ongoing collaboration with undesirable elements. Significantly, the main theatre

of action remains Balochistan, where the overall death toll rose by 241 per cent, from 109 in June to 372 in July. Similarly, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) registered 154 deaths in July, compared with 75 in June, marking an increase of over 100 per cent. The prevailing pattern of terror consists of suicide bombings and explosives-laden vehicles being rammed into security checkpoints or police stations. That law enforcement personnel and peace committee members are prime targets highlights the terror syndicate's aim to impair their resilience. Furthermore, attacks on civilians, including Chinese engineers and China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) personnel, indicate that "hostile" forces inimical to Pakistan are determined to derail the growing momentum of geoeconomics in the region.

Pakistan, meanwhile, tries in vain to appear resilient. There is public discourse over the factors that have allowed terrorism to increase. According to Pakistani security analysts, the immediate priority is a synchronised roadmap that integrates political will with military "capability" to dismantle terrorist networks decisively and effectively.

More specifically, the death toll from the August 2 suicide bombing outside Kabal Police Station in Swat rose to 17 on August 3, with seven policemen among those killed, as the KP government ordered a full-scale operation against terrorists and renewed efforts to restore peace. According to an updated list released by the Swat police spokesperson, the victims included seven police officials and 10 civilians, while 27 others - 18 policemen and nine civilians - sustained injuries. The atmosphere across Swat



Pakistan's terror landscape continues to look grim

UNLESS PAKISTAN STRENGTHENS INTELLIGENCE AND PROFESSIONALISES ITS SECURITY APPARATUS, IT CANNOT CONTAIN THE TERRORISM THAT HAS DEEPLY AFFLICTED THE COUNTRY

remained sombre. In solidarity with the affected families and to condemn the attack, the local trader community called for a complete shutdown in Kabal and surrounding areas on August 3. Trader leaders strongly denounced the attack and declared that Swat's peace would not be allowed to be disturbed. Nevertheless, Pakistan's terror landscape continues to look grim, with few signs of improvement in the foreseeable future.

Reacting to the attack, President Asif Ali Zardari and Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif condemned the bombing, vowing to continue the fight against terrorism. Such statements, however, routinely fade once the dust settles.

It is relevant to recall that the Swat Valley was once a stronghold of Islamic militants who imposed a strict interpretation of Sharia before the Pakistani military launched a major operation in 2007 and restored government control. However, terrorists have resurfaced in Swat in recent months, fuelling fears that the TTP is seeking to regain a foothold. Pakistan has also long accused Afghanistan's Taliban government of harbouring TTP militants, an allegation Kabul denies.

Against this backdrop, Somalia and Pakistan signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on August 4 between their respective defence ministries to strengthen bilateral cooperation in defence,

security and military capability development. Signed in Islamabad by Somali Defence Minister Ahmed Moallim Fiqi and Pakistan Defence Minister Khawaja Muhammad Asif, the agreement provides a framework for cooperation in counter-terrorism, military training, exchange of expertise, defence capability development and security.

The deal appears counterintuitive at a time when Islamabad is battling severe internal unrest in Balochistan, KP and Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir. A section of the media views the agreement as Pakistan possibly stepping in to complement Turkey's sustained military presence in Somalia.

Turkey already maintains a major training mission in Somalia through Camp TURKSOM. This could possibly form part of moves by an emerging Islamic grouping involving Saudi Arabia, Turkey, Pakistan and Qatar on the North Africa-West Asia chessboard. Alongside Saudi Arabia's recent announcement of a 14-member maritime coalition against the Houthis, it could also lead to greater Turkey-Pakistan coordinated naval activity in the Red Sea, Gulf of Aden and off the Horn of Africa. These developments call for scrutiny by the concerned agencies.

Whatever Pakistan may do to enter into security-linked arrangements with Somalia, Turkey, Saudi Arabia and other countries of the Islamic bloc, unless it addresses its own internal security concerns through robust intelligence machinery and a professional security apparatus, it cannot expect to contain the terrorism that has deeply afflicted the country.

Views expressed are personal

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Third Tower, 3rd Floor,
New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Sanjay Kumar/ Shailbala Bharti/ LBGH200005109263	House No.17-H/ 309, Second Floor, Without Roof Rights, Green View Heights, Sector 17H, Vasundhra Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 201001/ August 13, 2026	April 16, 2026 Rs. 11,22,397.00/-	Delhi NCR
2.	Narendra Pal Madan- Deceased (Through His Legal Heir/ Neelam Madan LBDEL00001322009	House No. III F/ 182, Situated at Sector III-F, Residential Colony Vaishali, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 201010/ August 13, 2026	January 28, 2026 Rs. 45,03,539.90/-	Delhi NCR

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 18, 2026
Place: Delhi Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

News at a glance

Rupee falls 19 paise to close at 95.61 against US dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 19 paise to close at 95.61 against the US dollar on Monday, amid weak domestic equity markets and a surge in crude oil prices. At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.50 against the greenback and traded in a range of 95.49-95.62 during the session. It eventually settled at 95.61, lower by 19 paise from its previous close.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.40, down 0.26 per cent.

Gold rebounds by ₹600 to ₹1,56,800 lakh per 10 grams

NEW DELHI: Gold prices rebounded by Rs 600 to Rs 1,56,800 per 10 grams in the national capital on Monday as a weak US dollar and firm global trends breathed fresh life into bullion demand.

However, silver remained flat at Rs 2,40,000 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes) for the second straight session, according to local traders.

The recovery extended to the international markets, with spot gold trading 0.48 per cent higher at \$4,397.59 per ounce. Silver rose more than 1 per cent to \$65.58 per ounce.

Six REITs distribute ₹3,136 cr to 5 lakh unitholders in 1st qtr

NEW DELHI: India's six listed REITs distributed Rs 3,136 crore to nearly 5 lakh unitholders in June quarter, according to industry data. The six listed REITs are Brookfield India Real Estate Trust, Embassy Office Parks REIT, Mindspace Business Parks REIT, Nexus Select Trust, Knowledge Realty Trust & Bagmane Prime Office.

In a statement on Monday, the Indian REITs Association said that these six listed REITs collectively distributed Rs 3,136 crore to more than 4.85 lakh unitholders during the first quarter of FY27.

Shabnam Sinha to be new Airtel Payments Bank Chief

NEW DELHI: Airtel Payments Bank on Monday announced leadership changes as Sunil Mittal concludes his tenure as non-executive Chairman and steps down from the board, effective September 30, 2026. Shabnam Sinha will assume the role of Chairperson for a three-year term beginning October 1, 2026, following her appointment by the Board and approval by the RBI, according to a company release.

Mittal, Founder and Chairman, Bharti Enterprises, was appointed as Non-Executive Chairman of Airtel Payments Bank in April 2016.

INVESTMENTS IN 5 ROUNDS TOP RS 69,000 CRORE

Centre clears 31 fresh electronics component projects worth ₹7,877 cr

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

The government on Monday approved 31 fresh proposals under the ambitious Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), involving investments of Rs 7,877 crore, taking the total number of projects cleared across five tranches to 106 with cumulative investments surpassing Rs 69,000 crore.

After awarding approval certificates to players, Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw noted the scheme has attracted private investments that have exceeded targets set originally.

“When we made the Electronic Components Scheme, the manufacturing scheme, we kept a target of Rs 59,000 crore. I am so glad the scheme has already achieved Rs 69,000 crore investment. Private investment is happening now, and it is coming in very crucial sectors,” Vaishnaw said. The approvals come as India looks to deepen domestic value



Electronics & IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw

THE SCHEME HAS ATTRACTED PRIVATE INVESTMENTS THAT HAVE EXCEEDED TARGETS SET ORIGINALLY

addition in electronics by strengthening local supply chains, reducing dependence on imports of critical components and building advanced manufacturing capabilities. It is in line with the government's broader goal of positioning India as a global hub for electronics manufacturing.

Electronics and IT Secretary S Krishnan announced that Meity (the Ministry of Electronics and IT) has cleared almost 31 applications, in the latest round,

KEY POINTS

- » 'Private investment is happening now, and it is coming in very crucial sectors,' Vaishnaw said
- » It is in line with the government's broader goal of positioning India as a global hub for electronics manufacturing
- » Vaishnaw said the fresh approvals will result in a total output or production of goods worth Rs 82,243 crore and lead to the generation of close to 10,000 jobs

involving a total investment of Rs 7,877 crore.

The approvals involve projects in areas such as capital goods, camera modules, display modules, connectors, anode material, enclosures, rare earth permanent magnets, speakers and microphones, antenna, metallised films for capacitors, and coils, among others.

The specific proposals greenlit in the latest round include Jyoti CNC Automation (Rs 1,021 crore), Micro-

max Precision Moulding (Rs 565 crore), VVDN Technologies (Rs 100 crore), Resolute Group's SkyQuad Electronics and Appliances (Rs 740 crore), Mitsubishi Electric India (Rs 99 crore), Wipro Global Engineering and Electronic Materials (Rs 1,033 crore additional investment), Gruner India (Rs 79 crore), Centum Electronics (Rs 54 crore).

The list of proposals also includes GX Group, Bhagwati Products, Ennovi Mobility Solutions, Allied Engineering Works, Globe Capacitors, Syrma SGS Technology, Rosenberger Interconnect, Sensata Technologies, and Britannia RFID Technologies, among others.

Vaishnaw said the fresh approvals will result in a total output or production of goods worth Rs 82,243 crore and lead to the generation of close to 10,000 jobs. The fresh proposals saw Wipro Global scaling up investments in copper clad laminate, a category that is seeing a shortage as well as price rise due to pent up demand in artificial

intelligence servers.

Quantum Magnetics has received approval for producing rare earth magnets - a segment that is dominated by China, which is crucial for all high-tech electronics products, especially to support advanced audio technologies. Companies like Mitsubishi Electric, Ind Sphinx, Accurate Gauging and Instruments, VVDN Technologies and Jyoti CNC Automation received approval for capital goods - a key segment to reduce dependence on imports and help Indian electronics manufacturers scale up their production.

The fresh tranche of investment will be spread across 10 states. The Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), launched in April 2025, offers incentives for setting up domestic manufacturing facilities. Vaishnaw reiterated that the industry must keep a razor-sharp focus on four key areas, including design capabilities, indigenous supply chain, Six Sigma quality, and workforce development.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday said the government would soon constitute a high-level panel on 'Banking for Viksit Bharat' to draw up a blueprint to create lenders capable of meeting the financing needs of a developed India.

In this year's Budget, the finance minister had proposed a high-level committee on 'Banking for Viksit Bharat' to comprehensively review the sector and align it with India's next phase of growth.

Addressing the two-day PSB Confluence here, Sitharaman said, "The intensive discussions of today and tomorrow come at a time we expect the announcement on the high-powered committee to look into banking for Viksit Bharat. Sooner, the committee will be announced."

She expressed hope that the deliberation at the two-day meeting would provide substantive material for the committee also to look at.

"So the committee would probably have that material before them even as they deliberate. And even as they deliberate, to give us their thoughts and also the recommendations



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

which will help us to clearly understand where the committee wants India to go towards Viksit Bharat and in that the role of banks," she said. Emphasising that the Viksit Bharat goal of 2047 is actually not too far away, she said, "your NPAs are at the lowest ever Indian banking has seen, and therefore there cannot be a better position of strength with which you can take on reforms."

"I propose setting up a high-level committee on 'Banking for Viksit Bharat' to comprehensively review the sector and align it with India's next phase of growth, while safeguarding financial stability, inclusion and consumer protection," she had said in the Budget speech on February 1.

Speaking at Monday's event, Financial Services Secretary Sanjay Lohia said it is imperative for public

sector banks to sustain the current momentum, especially as competition is becoming sharper.

"Technology is reshaping business models, customer experiences are evolving, and new areas of economic activity are emerging rapidly," he said.

Therefore, state-owned banks must continue to strengthen their competitiveness, growth within the domestic financial landscape, and against evolving global benchmarks, he said.

"This will require the institutions to anticipate opportunities, deepen sectoral expertise, and continuously adapt their capabilities, products and business models," he said.

"Financial institutions also have an important role where specialised expertise and financing structures can complement the scale and reach of banks," he said.

The two-day deliberation is structured around seven key themes: deposit mobilisation, banking for youth, supporting the investment cycle, supporting global capability centres, agriculture and horticulture value-chain infrastructure, re-imagining the credit card business and priority sector lending.

L&T bags ultra-mega order in Middle East to develop multiple offshore facilities

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Larsen & Toubro (L&T) on Monday said it has bagged a ultra-mega order in the Middle East for the development of multiple offshore facilities.

The company classifies orders worth over Rs 15,000 crore as 'ultra-mega'.

L&T Energy Hydrocarbon Offshore (LTEH Offshore) will undertake the engineering, procurement, construction, installation and commissioning (EPCIC) of offshore facilities, the company said in a filing to BSE.

The award of the project reinforces LTEH Offshore's long-standing presence in the Middle East and reflects the confidence placed by customers in its ability to deliver large and complex offshore projects safely, on schedule and to the highest quality standards.

Backed by integrated in-house engineering, project management, procurement, fabrication and installation capabilities and a fleet of vessels, LTEH Offshore has delivered some of the region's most challenging offshore developments.

L&T is a \$32 billion Indian multinational engaged in engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) projects, hi-tech manufacturing, products and services.

Tata Sons AGM may be adjourned over trust representation issue

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Tata Sons' Annual General Meeting (AGM), scheduled for Tuesday, August 18, is likely to be adjourned as Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), a key shareholder, is unable to nominate a representative due to a regulatory restriction imposed by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner, people familiar with the matter said.

The AGM is scheduled to consider, among other matters, the directorship of Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran, who has decided not to seek another term after his current tenure ends in February.

It will also consider the

company's FY26 financial statements and dividend declaration.

Tata Sons is expected to proceed with the meeting but adjourn it if the required quorum is not met.

Under Article 86 of its Articles of Association, at least five members must be present, including a representative jointly nominated by SRTT and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT), provided the two trusts together hold at least 40 per cent of Tata Sons. SRTT holds 23.56 per cent and SDTT 27.98 per cent.

The issue stems from a May order by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner directing SRTT to defer a

trustee meeting and ordering an inquiry into the composition of its board.

SRTT has six trustees, including three lifetime trustees-Jimmy Naval Tata, Jehangir HC Jehangir and Noel Naval Tata-constituting 50 per cent of the board, against the 25 per cent ceiling under Section 30A(2) of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act.

Tata Trusts has argued that the amendment is prospective and does not apply to perpetual trustee appointments made before September 1, 2025. If the AGM is adjourned for want of quorum, Chandrasekaran would remain a director until a valid AGM is held, people said.

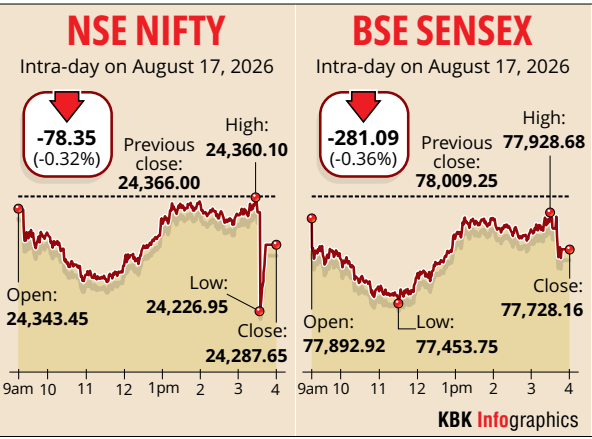
Sensex drops 281 points, Nifty falls for 5th straight day amid rising oil prices

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 17

Benchmark Sensex dropped by 281 points, while the broader Nifty fell for the fifth straight session on Monday, due to selling in IT, FMCG, and telecom shares amid rising crude oil prices and persistent geopolitical tensions in West Asia.

The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 281.09 points, or 0.36 per cent, to settle at 77,728.16.

Falling for the fifth consecutive day, the 50-share NSE Nifty declined 78.35 points, or 0.32 per cent, to end at 24,287.65, taking the losses to the fifth day.



From the Sensex pack, Infosys, HCL Tech, Sun Pharma, TCS, Tech Mahindra and ITC were among the biggest laggards.

Tata Steel, Axis Bank,

Reliance Industries and Bharat Electronics were among the winners.

The BSE SmallCap Select index was up 0.38 per cent, while MidCap Select index

dipped 0.11 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, IT dropped 1.74 per cent, followed by Focused IT (1.56 per cent), Telecommunication (1.16 per cent), Hospitals (0.94 per cent), FMCG (0.79 per cent), Healthcare (0.56 per cent), Services (0.48 per cent) and Consumer Durables (0.44 per cent).

Realty climbed 1.38 per cent, followed by Metal jumped 1.03 per cent, Capital Goods (0.78 per cent), Industrials (0.60 per cent) and Commodities (0.45 per cent).

FIIs bought equities worth Rs 508.12 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

Unemployment rate dips to 5.1% in July Rural UR across genders and urban male UR declined

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 17

Overall unemployment rate among persons aged 15 years and above declined to 5.1 per cent in July 2026 from 5.5 per cent in the previous month, according to a government survey.

According to the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) conducted by the National Statistics Office (NSO), released on Monday, the Unemployment Rate (UR) among persons aged 15 years and above was

4.5 per cent in rural areas, down from 5 per cent in the previous month. The urban UR remained almost steady at 6.7 per cent in July 2026 compared to 6.6 per cent in June 2026.

Compared with July 2025, the overall UR and rural UR remained broadly stable in July 2026, whereas the urban UR decreased by 0.5 percentage point from 7.2 per cent in July 2025.

Rural UR across genders and urban male UR declined, it stated.

Among males aged 15

years and above, the overall UR declined from 5.3 per cent in June 2026 to 5.0 per cent in July 2026. This is also lower by 0.3 percentage points as compared to July 2025 (5.3 per cent).

The rural male UR declined from 4.9 per cent in June 2026 to 4.6 per cent in July 2026 and was at the same level observed in July, 2025. While the urban male UR maintained broad stability in comparison with the previous month, it declined by 0.7 percentage point to 5.9 per cent in July 2026

against 6.6 per cent in July, 2025.

For females aged 15 years and above, the overall and rural UR in July 2026 decreased in comparison to June 2026. However, it remained above the level observed a year ago in July, 2025.

The urban female UR increased by 0.4 percentage points to 8.8 per cent in July 2026 from 8.4 per cent in June 2026, while it remained broadly stable compared with the July 2025 level (8.7 per cent).

ANI NEWS
Mumbai, August 17

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday declared that non-performing assets (NPAs) in Indian banking have fallen to their lowest-ever level, telling public sector bank chiefs at the inaugural session of PSB Confluence 2026 that lenders are now in their strongest-ever position to drive reform.

Addressing top bank leadership at the two-day conclave, she said the Department of Financial Services (DFS) had, for the

first time in her tenure, prepared detailed research documents on all seven themes chosen for discussion at the meet. She singled out the document on youth as particularly striking, noting it breaks down India's young population by age and life stage, and pointed out that nearly 29% of Indians fall between the ages of 15 and 29 a demographic she said banks must factor into their planning.

The minister said the seven papers, shared in advance with participants, drew on global best practices and were meant to

be studied closely so that deliberations could yield concrete, actionable ideas rather than broad statements of intent. "Workable," she said, "because you have given the ideas you're the ones who are going to take it forward."

She linked the timing of the confluence to an expected announcement of a high-powered committee on banking for a Viksit Bharat, saying the outcomes of this meet would give that panel substantive material to work with as it frames recommendations on the sector's future role.

PLEA ON 'UNPREDICTABLE FLUCTUATIONS' IN AIRFARES

Aviation Rules to be finalised in 3 weeks: Centre tells Supreme Court

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 17

The Centre told the Supreme Court on Monday that it has fast-tracked the framing of rules under the Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024, which is aimed at modernising India's aviation sector, and that the same would be finalised within three weeks.

The government placed the draft rules before a bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta in a sealed cover, and said some final discussions are going on.

"You publish this within seven days," the bench said, adding, "if airlines are not complying, ground them."

Additional Solicitor General Anil Kaushik, appearing in the matter for the Centre, told the bench that the rules would be finalised within three weeks.

"We have fast-tracked the framing of rules. Give us three weeks, we will come out with the finalised version," he said.

The court was hearing a plea filed by social activist S Laxminarayanan,



THE GOVERNMENT PLACED THE DRAFT RULES BEFORE A BENCH OF JUSTICES VIKRAM NATH AND SANDEEP MEHTA IN A SEALED COVER

who has sought a robust and independent regulator that ensures transparency and passenger protection across the civil aviation sector and regulatory guidelines to control the "unpredictable fluctuations" in airfare and ancillary charges imposed by private airlines in India.

Senior advocate Ravindra Srivastava, appearing in the matter for the petitioner, told the bench that till the time the new rules come into force, the old rules are operating.

KEY POINTS

- » 'You publish this within seven days, the bench said, adding, if airlines are not complying, ground them'
- » Additional Solicitor General Anil Kaushik, appearing in the matter for the Centre, told the bench that the rules would be finalised within three weeks
- » 'We have fast-tracked the framing of rules. Give us three weeks, we will come out with the finalised version,' he said

The bench perused the draft rules placed before it in the sealed cover.

"There is a mechanism suggested but regulator, we are not sure," it observed.

It noted that Kaushik has requested for some more time to get the draft rules finalised and place before the bench within three weeks and posted the matter for hearing on September 7.

On July 13, the top court had asked the Centre to place the rules framed under the Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024, before it.

It had said the rules be placed before it in a sealed cover, irrespective of whether those have been placed before Parliament.

While hearing the plea on May 15, the apex court said there should be some rationalisation of airfares and asked the Centre to provide relief to flyers.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who was then appearing in the matter for the Centre, had told the bench that the new enactment of 2024 had come into effect in January 2025

and the corresponding rules were in the process of being prepared.

On November 17 last year, the top court sought responses from the Centre and others on Laxminarayanan's plea seeking a robust and independent regulator that ensures transparency and passenger protection across the civil aviation sector.

While hearing the matter in January, the top court said it would interfere with the "unpredictable fluctuations" in airfares and flagged the exorbitant rise during festivals.

It had termed the exorbitant rise in airfares by the airlines "exploitation" and asked the Centre and the Directorate General of Civil Aviation to file their replies on the plea.

The plea claims that all private airlines have, without any credible justification, reduced the free check-in baggage allowance for economy-class passengers from 25 kg to 15 kg, "thereby converting what was earlier part of the ticketed service into a new revenue stream".

'CAS here to stay, Sebi reviewing feedback for improvements'

Sebi chief, however, declined to immediately specify the exact tweaks which could be made to the CAS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, August 17

Sebi Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey on Monday made it clear that the recently introduced Closing Auction Session (CAS) framework is "here to stay", and the capital markets regulator is analysing feedback to understand if some improvements can be made on issues faced by the stakeholders.

Pandey, however, declined to immediately specify the exact tweaks which could be made to the CAS, which came into effect from August 3 this year, and has led some participants to point out certain shortcomings, especially on social media platforms.

"The CAS is here to stay for sure, only we will see if there are certain constraints or certain issues that we can improve, certainly we will improve," Pandey told reporters on the sidelines of an event on cybersecurity arranged at the Sebi-promoted National Institute of Securities Markets on the outskirts of the financial capital.

He maintained that Sebi



Sebi Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey

“WHEN YOU HAVE SOMETHING GOING ON FOR YEARS AND YEARS, THEY FEEL THAT CHANGE WILL NEVER COME. WE DO NOT PUT IN ENERGY INTO LEARNING A NEW SYSTEM”

cannot be reacting to every suggestion being floated or to every critique of the move which he termed as a major reform in the markets.

"We are looking at all the suggestions, I have myself seen a number of suggestions which have come from social media. Our teams have gone through

it, they are discussing with the participants," the career bureaucrat-turned-regulator said, making it clear that there are a certain set of objectives which the regulator is seeking to meet.

He also said that many of the concerns can get eliminated once the participation in the CAS goes up and also added that many participants are on systems aligned to the older volume-weighted average price framework due to which they are unable to enjoy the benefits of CAS.

Pandey, who has previously maintained that frameworks similar to CAS are in use in other countries and called out India as a late adaptor, also wondered if the market participants did not put in the required efforts to understand the new framework.

"When you have something going on for years and years, they feel that change will never come. We do not put in energy into learning a new system," he said.

Pandey also spoke about the Sebi getting congratulatory messages from many stakeholders for introducing CAS.

Mobius Foundation to Host 8th ICSE from September 2-3

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 17

With the 2030 deadline approaching and progress on the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) lagging targets, Mobius Foundation will host the 8th International Conference on Sustainability Education (ICSE) on September 2-3, at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi.

Themed "Sustainability Education for Transformative Action", the two-day conference will bring together policymakers, educators, researchers, development practitioners.

Discussions will focus on strengthening education beyond awareness to develop skills, leadership, systems thinking and capacities needed to accelerate collective action on the SDGs.

BoI launches 'BOINZ Freedom' mobile app in New Zealand

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 17

Bank of India (New Zealand) Ltd launched its new mobile banking application, "BOINZ - Freedom", at a special gathering in Auckland on the occasion of India's 80th Independence Day, attended by around 500 guests.

The app was inaugurated by the Consul General of India, Auckland,

while Bank of India MD & CEO Rajneesh Karnatak addressed the gathering through a video message.

The launch marks a step towards strengthening the Bank of India's digital presence in New Zealand, where it has operated since 2011 through its wholly owned subsidiary, BOI(NZ)L, with branches in Auckland and Papatoetoe.

The app symbolises

the "freedom to bank anytime, anywhere" and reinforces the bank's "Relationship Beyond Banking" philosophy.

Key features include domestic and international remittances to India, biometric authentication, secure m-PIN login, TDS certificate downloads, account statements for savings, current and loan accounts, and scheduled payments.

IRCTC intensifies drive against unapproved food, beverages

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 17

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) has intensified inspections to curb the sale of unapproved food, beverages and packaged drinking water on trains and at stations.

Quick Response Teams

(QRTs), along with railway commercial departments, are conducting checks to ensure compliance with food safety and hygiene standards.

In Lucknow, 117 trains were inspected between July 28 and August 8, resulting in the seizure of 5,241 bottles of unapproved packaged drink-

ing water. In Chandigarh, 51 trains were inspected and 3,108 bottles seized. At Ambala, QRTs seized 13 cartons of unapproved products, including ice cream and flavoured milk. Similar inspections at Saharanpur also resulted in seizures of unapproved food, beverages and packaged drinking water.

Vellore Institute of Technology Chennai hosts its 14th Annual Convocation

MPOST BUREAU

Chennai, August 17

Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), Chennai, held its 14th annual convocation on Sunday, August 16, 2026, with Dr T. Ramasami, former Secretary, Department of Science and Technology, Government of India, as Chief Guest.

Mohit Jain, Chief Operating Officer (Publishing) and Board Member, Bennett, Coleman & Co. Ltd., was the Guest of Honour, while Dr Ganesanathan Geathiswaran, Deputy High Commissioner of Sri Lanka, South India, attended as Special Guest.

VIT Founder and Chancellor Dr G. Viswanathan presided over the ceremony. VIT Vice Presidents Dr Sankar Viswanathan and Dr G.V. Selvam, Vice Chancellor Dr V.S. Kanachana Bhaaskaran, Pro-Vice Chancellors Dr T. Thyagarajan and Dr Partha



CONGRATULATING 4,518 UG, PG AND PHD GRADUATES, VISWANATHAN SAID ONLY AROUND 13 PER CENT OF INDIA'S POPULATION HAD ATTAINED GRADUATE-LEVEL EDUCATION

Sharathi Mallick, Directors Dr K. Sathiyarayanan, Registrar Dr Jayabarathi T and Additional Registrar Dr P.K. Manoharan also attended.

Congratulating 4,518 UG, PG and PhD graduates, Viswanathan said

only around 13 per cent of India's population had attained graduate-level education. He stressed the need to expand higher education, noting that India's growth in this area remained behind several developed countries.

Ramasami said youth have an important role in shaping their own future, families, the country and humanity.

He noted Tamil Nadu's emergence as a leader in research and development since 2000, with the State accounting for about 61 per cent of research papers published in India, including 35 per cent contributed by private universities.

He credited institutions such as VIT with contributing significantly to higher education and nation-building.

Jain urged graduates to pursue happiness, work hard, compete and build teams while developing solutions to unresolved challenges.

Geathiswaran highlighted the deep historical, cultural, religious, linguistic and social ties between India and Sri Lanka, particularly between Tamil Nadu and Sri Lanka.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Braithwaite & Co. Ltd celebrated 80th Independence Day at its Corporate Office, Kolkata Works. The celebrations commenced with the singing of 'Vande Mataram', followed by the unfurling of the National Flag by Naveen Kumar, CMD, in the presence of Sanjeev Rastogi, Director (Production). The ceremony concluded with the singing of the National Anthem.



IRFC celebrated the 80th Independence Day with great enthusiasm, dignity & patriotic spirit. On the occasion, Manoj Kumar Dubey, CMD, IRFC, unfurled the National Flag in presence of Ranjay Chaudhary, Director (Finance), Manish Chandra, Executive Director (HR), Deepa Kotnis, Executive Director (Finance).



SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFML), as part of its CSR commitment has launched two MobileYES Clinic Vans in partnership with VisionSpring Foundation. The initiative is designed to improve access to primary eyecare services for underserved communities across New Delhi and Bangalore.



POWERGRID was conferred with PMIS Recognition of Partner Company Award under the category 'Innovation in Exit Pathways' on Friday. The award was received by Dr. Yatindra Dwivedi, Director (Personnel) along with B K Mundu (ED-HRD) from Dr. Pallavi Jain Govil, Secretary (MCA) at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi.

FICCI CASCADE holds Inter-School Competition 'ZERO-EVASION'

The event saw participation from 620 students representing more than 91 schools across Delhi/NCR

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 17

FICCI CASCADE on Monday hosted the 8th edition of its Inter-School Competition, themed "ZERO-EVASION: Youth Driving Change Against Smuggling and Counterfeiting", at FICCI, Federation House, New Delhi.

The event saw participation from 620 students representing more than 91 schools across Delhi/NCR. Students competed in Elocution, Poster-Making and Jingle Writing, using their creativity to highlight the economic, social and national security implications of smuggling and counterfeiting.

The jury comprised



Hem Kumar Pande, Former Secretary, Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, Government of India and Think Tank Member, FICCI CASCADE; Sanjeev Tripathi, Former Chief, Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) and Think Tank Member, FICCI CASCADE; and Deep Chand, Former Special Commissioner of Police, New Delhi and Advisor, FICCI CASCADE.

Pande said young consumers' purchasing choices

can have wider implications for legitimate businesses, consumer safety and the economy, and stressed the need to foster informed and vigilant citizens. Tripathi said awareness among young citizens is crucial to addressing illicit trade and that programmes such as ZERO-EVASION enable students to understand the challenges and inspire greater awareness. Deep Chand called for collective efforts involving society and enforcement agen-

cies, saying young citizens can become advocates for responsible choices.

In the Elocution competition, Abeer Dubey of Indrapuram Public School won first place, followed by Sanjana Prasanth of Mother Mary's School, Mayur Vihar, in second and Sumit Singh Dhilian of Evergreen Public School, Vasundhara Enclave, in third.

In Poster-Making, Anaya Trivedi of Birla Vidya Niketan, Pushp Vihar secured first place, Biswajeet Saha of Mount Columbus School, New Delhi was second, and Aaradhya Negi of Lotus Valley International School, Gurugram was third. Akshi Jain of Salwan Public School, Gurugram received the consolation prize.



ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
भूखण्ड सं.-01, सेक्टर-नॉर्जेमार्क-4, ग्रेटर नोएडा, जवाहर गौतमबुद्धनगर (उ.प्र.)
वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in | ई-मेल: authority@gnida.in

पत्रांक: वरि. प्र. / (वर्क सकिंल-5) /2026/10253 दिनांक: 17.08.2026

आर.एफ.पी. / ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (वर्क सकिंल-5) ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नोएडा की ओर से ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- वरि. प्र. वर्क सकिंल-5/2026/10252 दिनांक- 17.08.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम संख्या-01 पर अंकित कार्य की ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा की समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नोएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in पर ई-निविदा लिंक एवं ई-पोर्टल <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।

क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम /वर्क सकिंल	अनुमानित लागत
1.	ग्रेटर नोएडा प्राधिकरण कार्यालय भवन के टावर-2 में ग्राउंड फ्लोर रिसेप्शन, 6th फ्लोर, 7th फ्लोर, 8th फ्लोर, एवं 9th फ्लोर पर इंटिरियर, एम.ई.पी. का कार्य एवं एम.ई.पी. सर्विस का कार्य। (वर्क सकिंल-5)	आइडम रेट

क्रम सं. 01 पर अंकित दिनांक 19.07.2026 से 01.09.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है, एवं प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 03.09.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (वर्क सकिंल-5)
Follow Us On  OfficialGNIDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Uday Singh Maan S/o Kapoor Singh, R/o: H. No. -462, Village Prahladpur, Banger, Delhi** (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 727/2017, U/s 279/337 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Shahbad Diary, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Uday Singh Maan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Uday Singh Maan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Uday Singh Maan** accused **FIR No. 727/2017, U/s 279/337 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Shahbad Diary, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (N)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11422/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Deepak Paswan @ Chotu @ Kliya S/o Manoj Paswan R/o Jhuggi Sec-26, Rohini, Outer North, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 331/19 Dt. 27.07.2019 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act IPC at PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak Paswan @ Chotu @ Kliya** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak Paswan @ Chotu @ Kliya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deepak Paswan @ Chotu @ Kliya** of **FIR No. 331/19 Dt. 27.07.2019 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act of PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
North, Room No.114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11002/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ramesh S/o Jahan Singh R/o D-2/228 Sultanpuri Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 249/2022 U/s 279/338 IPC at PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ramesh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ramesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ramesh** of **FIR No. 249/2022 U/s 279/338 IPC of PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
North, Room No.114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10954/ON/2026



UJVNL Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 688 **TENDER NOTICE** Date: 17.08.2026
Office of the Executive Engineer (G), Chilla Powerhouse invites bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:
Tender No: 08/EEG/Chilla/2026-27.
Name of work/supply/services etc.: Annual Mechanized Cleaning & Sweeping of Chilla Powerhouse.
Estimated cost: Rs 18,42,390/- Plus GST extra.
Date of availability of bid document on website: 18.08.2026 from 16:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 08.09.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For full & further details, kindly visit Nigam's website i.e <http://ujvnl.com>
Executive Engineer (G)

“AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY”

NORTHERN RAILWAY E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location	Provision of Model OHE in TRD Depots at TKD, PTNR, GHM, MDNR, MUT, SMQL & GZB over Delhi Division.
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 33,12,347.21/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 66,300/-
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	25.08.2026 (00:00 Hrs.) to 08.09.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	08.09.2026 (15:00 hrs.)
6	Fund Allocation	07041032
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
E-Tender No.: 26-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 17.08.2026		2846/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE		

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sanjeet Haldar, S/o: Lakhan Haldar, R/o: Jhuggi No. 586, Near Pump House, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 975/2022, U/s: 392/394/395/397/34 IPC, Police Station Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sanjeet Haldar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sanjeet Haldar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sanjeet Haldar of Police Station Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Jagmohan Singh
ASJ-03, North, Room No. 312,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11425/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sidharath @ Golu S/o Sunil Singh R/o WZ 18, Dasghara, Todapur, Inderpuri, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 222/2024 U/s 305(1)/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sidharath @ Golu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sidharath @ Golu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sidharath @ Golu** of case **FIR No. 222/2024 U/s 305(1)/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Central, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10282/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kuljeet Singh Chahal S/o Ram Kishan Chahal R/o 98, Defence Enclave, Vikas Marg, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.559/2006 U/S 147/148/427/323/506/34 IPC, PS Pandav Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Kuljeet Singh Chahal** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Kuljeet Singh Chahal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kuljeet Singh Chahal of FIR No.559/2006 U/S 147/148/427/323/506/34 IPC, PS Pandav Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Amit Rana
First Class-03, CJM
Room No.16, East
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11460/ED/2026(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of Work and its location: 105-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27; Electrical work in connection with (i) Provision of 2 Family suits and 6 individual suits at ORH GZB in lieu of Old ORH. (ii) Construction of underground tank & pump house, electric sub-station, improvement of water supply system under ADEN/GZB (iii) Augmentation of homing capacity of ELS/GZB from 200 to 225. (iv) Reorganization of facilities available in Shed and shop at ELS/GZB. (v) Provision of effluent treatment plant at ELS/GZB.
Approx. cost of the works in: Rs. 1,19,09,661.90/-
Address of the office: Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money: Rs. 2,38,200.00/-
Last Date & Time of submission of tender: 08.09.2026, 13:00 Hrs.
Opening of tender: 08.09.2026, 13:00 Hrs.
Website & notice board: www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2835/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manthan Rana S/o Santosh R/o B-273, Gali No.6, Kunj Gali, North Ghonda, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.408/20 U/S 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS Bhajan Pura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Manthan Rana** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manthan Rana** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manthan Rana of FIR No.408/20 U/S 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS Bhajan Pura, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Kirandeep Kaur
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No.05, 2nd Floor, North East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11492/NE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Gopal Krishan Jassal Partner, M/s Travel Expertz, R/o A-5C/5B, Janakpuri, B-1, Delhi-110058, 2) Nitish Arora Partner, M/s Travel Expertz, R/o Plot No. 14, Flat No. B-609, Sea Show Apartments, Dwarka, Sector-6, Delhi-110075** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI Act 2133/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Adarsh Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said 1) **Gopal Krishan Jassal, 2) Nitish Arora** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said 1) **Gopal Krishan Jassal, 2) Nitish Arora** has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said 1) **Gopal Krishan Jassal, 2) Nitish Arora** accused of **CC NI Act 2133/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Adarsh Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order - Sh. Aakash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, North
Room No. 213, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11419/NW/2026



UJVNL Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

पत्र सं०: 691 दिनांक: 17 / 08 / 2026

Short Term Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), Asan Barrage, 'Jal Shakti Bhawan', Dhakrani invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No. (1) T-01/EE (E&M)/AB/ (2026-27) & (2) T-05/EE (E&M)/AB/ (2026-27).

Name of work/supply/services etc.: (1) "Urgent Work of replacement & repairing of 6 No. Trash Rack Screen Panel of Head Regulator at Asan Barrage, Dhalipur" & (2) "Procurement of PPE & Safety Items at Asan Barrage, Dhalipur".

Estimated cost: (1) ₹ 7,42,000.00 only & GST extra & (2) ₹ 2,47,800.00 only & GST extra.

Date of availability of bid document on website: 18/08/2026
Last date for submission of tender : 03/09/2026 upto 11:00 hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (E&M)

“Avoid wasteful use of Electricity”

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dharmender Kumar, S/o Bhamber Singh R/o 16H/966, Bapa Nagar, Pyare Lal Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-05** Also at **E2/22, Shastri Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case No.514305/2016 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Karol Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar of Case No.514305/2016 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Karol Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Urvi Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act-01) Central
Room No.201, CBA-II, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11514/CD/2026

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED (A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)

No.02-16/CE(S&P)/TR-26/S&P/11/0734 Raipur, Dtd. 14-08-2026

E - BIDDING TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited by the undersigned through CSPTCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from experienced manufacturers/eligible bidders for Supply of following material-

S.N.	Tender no. /RFx No.	Description	Due Date & time
1.	TR- 26/S&P/11 RFx No.8100053675	Procurement of Thermovision Camera	08.09.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs

The details of NIT can be viewed from our website www.cspc.co.in and the Tender Documents can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal:- <https://ebidding.cspc.co.in:50724/irj/portal> Any amendment/corrigendum, if required, will be displayed on our website only.

CHIEF ENGINEER (S&P)

SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 48777/1 CSPTCL: RAIPUR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Rahul @ Vishnu, S/o: Sh. Pancham, R/o: H. No. C-140, Ph-1, Metro Vihar, Holambi Kalan, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 00385/2022, U/s: 356/379/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Rahul @ Vishnu**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Rahul @ Vishnu**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Rahul @ Vishnu, FIR No.:00385/2022, U/s: 356/379/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Room No. 06, Ground Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11244/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Lal Babu, S/o.: Sattaullah, R/o. E-3331, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case **FIR No.317/2022 U/S 356/379/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Lal Babu** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Lal Babu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Lal Babu**, accused of **Case FIR No. 317/2022 U/S 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.10.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North),
Room No. 114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11415/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. IRSHAD S/o Mohd. Amirul R/o Jhuggi No. 106, Raakhi Market Jakhira, Daya Basti, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No./CC No. 41/2023 U/s 356/379/411 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla Railway Station, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. IRSHAD** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. IRSHAD** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. IRSHAD of FIR No./CC No. 41/2023 U/s 356/379/411 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla Railway Station, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **19.11.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg (NDPS)
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II
(Central Distt.), Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11146/Rly/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Rakesh S/o Chunnur R/o C-23, Metro Vihar, Holambi Kalan, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 142/2020 Dt. 14.03.2020 U/s 392/411/34 IPC at PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rakesh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rakesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rakesh of FIR No. 142/2020 Dt. 14.03.2020 U/s 392/411/34 IPC of PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.

By order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Court No.06,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10874/ON/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY TENDER NOTICE

L.No.: JHS-ELG-W-T-09-2026-27 Date: 10.08.2026
For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Gen) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work:-

Tender No.: JHS-ELG-W-T-09-2026-27 Tender Value: Rs. 75.38,590/- only

Description of work: Electrical G work for: Part-A: Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi Extension of ROH shed in Jhansi. Part-B: JHS/E-Construction of (10*10) Ladies and Gents toilet in DRM office area.

Bid Security: Rs. 1,50,800/- only Completion period: 06 months

Closing date of tender: 02.09.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.)

Tenderer will submit the tender online upto 02.09.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.).

Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railways website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

1880/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SPINNERS SUTHAR, JADEJA SPARKLE AS DINUSHA’S TON IN VAIN

A ton of fight, but spin does the trick

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Galle, August 17

Indian bowlers met an unexpected obstacle in centurion Sonal Dinusha but the Manav Suthar-led unit carried enough grit to establish a sizable 178-run lead over Sri Lanka on the third day of the first Test here on Monday.

Sri Lanka were bowled out for 284 in their first innings as Suthar (4/76) and Ravindra Jadeja (3/57) led India’s attack with skill and verve.

Once the hosts were reduced to 99 for five at lunch, thanks to the early brilliance of left-arm spinner Suthar, the end seemed imminent for them.

But Dinusha, who made a crafty maiden international hundred of 100 off 168 balls, and the seasoned Niroshan Dickwella (80, 115b) added 146 runs off 216 balls for the sixth wicket to keep the rampaging Indian bowlers at bay.

They added 116 runs in the second session without losing a wicket.

Unlike their top-order colleagues, Dickwella and Dinusha were not in a hurry, showing a lot of judiciousness in shot selection



Manav Suthar celebrates after taking the wicket of Dinesh Chandimal

PTI

on a still good to bat pitch.

Sweep was a preferred mode of scoring for both the batters against Indian spinners, and the two Lankans displayed good skills from dispatching the balls from the stump line.

Dickwella, whose selection kicked up a lot of furore in local cricketing circles, reached his 50 off 67 balls, while his younger partner was much slower in reaching the little landmark in 92 balls.

However, Dickwella, who was dropped on 20 by KL Rahul at slip off Suthar, had a momentary lapse of concentration, edging pacer Prasidh Krishna to Rishabh Pant behind the stumps, a few minutes into the final session of the day.

However, Dinusha carried on and reached his hundred in 167 balls, but fell leg before to Jadeja in the very next ball.

The Dinusha-Dickwella alliance was a study class in

remarkable temperament and adequate technique while facing up to skillful spinners.

But the same cannot be said about the other batters in the Lankan top-order, who played with hard hands and drove away from body to get caught in awkward positions.

In the first session, the Indian bowlers led by left-arm spinner Suthar discovered immaculate lines to tear through the Sri

IN SHORT

- » Sri Lanka were bowled out for 284 in their first innings as Suthar (4/76) and Ravindra Jadeja (3/57) led India’s attack with skill and verve
- » Once the hosts were reduced to 99 for five at lunch, thanks to the early brilliance of left-arm spinner Suthar, the end seemed imminent for them

Lankan top-order.

India resumed from overnight 460 for 9, and added only a couple of runs to finish their first essay on 462.

The Lankans needed a solid start for a strong pursuit of that total and they received anything but that.

Lead pacer Mohammad Siraj struck with his second delivery of the innings to deal an early jolt to the Lankans.

Nishan Fernando, who was impressive for SLC XI in the warm-up match, could not handle Siraj’s away swing and bounce, snicking him to Devdutt Padikkal at first slip.

From 2-1 up to 2-4 down, error-prone India India pay the price

Fulton admits defensive lapses proved costly

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 17

Defensive lapses proved costly as India went down 2-4 to England in their second pool match of the men’s Hockey World Cup here on Sunday, leaving the Harmanpreet Singh-led side needing to avoid a defeat against arch-rivals Pakistan in their clash on Wednesday.

India, who had beaten Wales 3-1 in their opening match, staged a strong comeback to lead 2-1 at half-time in the Pool D match, but were completely outplayed in the third quarter, conceding two goals, before world No. 3 England added another in the final quarter.

Nicholas Bandaruk scored twice for England (14th and 55th minutes), while Stuart Rushmere (39th) and Henry Croft (43rd) were the other scorers for the winners.

Harmanpreet Singh (17th) and Dilpreet Singh (25th) scored India’s goals.

England lead Pool D with two wins from two matches, while India are second with three points. Pakistan, who drew with



INDIA HAD A STRONG FIRST HALF AND SCORED TWO GOALS IN THE SECOND QUARTER BUT STRUGGLED TO MAINTAIN THE SAME DEFENSIVE INTENSITY

Wales earlier in the day, are third with one point, with Wales -- also on one point -- at the bottom.

India will need to either beat or draw Pakistan in their final pool match on Wednesday to qualify for the second round. A loss against Pakistan, will, however, knock India out of the tournament.

The top two teams from the pool will advance to

the next round.

Fulton rues lapses

India head coach Craig Fulton admitted that his side’s defensive lapses in the third quarter proved.

India had a strong first half and scored two goals in the second quarter but struggled to maintain the same defensive intensity after the break.

“The first half was good. We got PCs on the counter-attack and came back nicely with a bit more control. In the third quarter our defence was not as good as it was supposed to be,” Fulton said.

Fulton, however, said India must quickly regroup for their final pool match against arch-rivals Pakistan on Wednesday in which they can’t afford to lose.

Navneet eyes hockey’s version of Harman’s feat

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 17

Inspired by Harmanpreet Kaur and her women’s cricket team, who created history by winning the ODI World Cup last year, veteran striker Navneet Kaur wants the Indian hockey team to script a similar

title-winning story at the FIH Women’s World Cup.

India, ranked ninth in the world, began its campaign with a fighting 2-2 draw against Paris Olympic silver medallist and world No. 4 China. They next face 18th-ranked South Africa on Tuesday. The Indian women’s cricket team’s

triumph over South Africa in the final last year, which earned them their maiden ODI World Cup title, has inspired women athletes across the country, Navneet believes.

“Everyone now knows the players of our women’s cricket team, which they didn’t know as much

before. As women players, it’s an inspiration for us. If that team can play so well at this level, why can’t we?” Navneet said. “Playing at the world level and winning a title by performing at your best is a huge thing, and we too would like to achieve this feat in hockey,” she added.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 17

Giant-killer Ayush Shetty produced the biggest upset of the BWF World Championships, stunning world No. 1 Shi Yu Qi of China in a thrilling battle to seal a memorable win and storm into the men’s singles sec-

Shetty makes waves with Shi scalp, Sindhu wins



ond round, while PV Sindhu also advanced com-

fortably in the women’s singles here on Monday.

Shetty continued his giant-killing run by adding Shi to his victims list. He defeated Shi 21-14 13-21 21-19. Sindhu began her bid for a historic sixth Worlds medal brightly, outclassing Ireland’s Sophia Noble 21-7, 21-11. Treasa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand too had an easy outing.

FILM

DEOL EXPLAINED HOW INSECURITY CAN SOMETIMES AFFECT RELATIONSHIPS WITHIN THE FILM INDUSTRY

‘I AM NOT AN INSECURE PERSON’

Sunny Deol opened up about Shah Rukh Khan feud and insecurity after ‘Darr’

Sunny Deol has always talked candidly about his long-standing equation with Shah Rukh Khan and the circumstances that created tension between them during the making of ‘Darr’. The 1993 film, which featured Shah Rukh as an obsessive character and Sunny as the protagonist, became one of the most discussed films of its time because of the unconventional treatment of its central characters.

Years after the film’s release, Sunny reflected on the differences between the two actors and explained how insecurity can sometimes affect relationships within the film industry. During a conversation with Shubhankar Mishra, Sunny was asked about his relationship with Shah Rukh and the period when they were working together. Deol acknowledged that there may have been some differences when they were younger but maintained that insecurity has never been part of his approach to work.

“At a younger age, like I won’t say that we don’t have a little something with each other. We do have that. And I have never



been like that. I am not an insecure person. I am never insecure on set. But because of insecurity, many actors do things which they don’t have to do. Because we can only be the character we are,” he said.

Sunny further explained that actors cannot go beyond what their characters require, but insecurity can sometimes influence their behaviour and ultimately affect the atmosphere on a film set.

“We cannot be anything beyond that. But somehow, quite a lot of actors feel very insecure. And because of that, the vibes go wrong. Things happen which don’t have to happen. But then, that’s the reality of our film industry,” he added.

When Sunny was asked whether he considers Shah Rukh a friend today, he offered a more professional perspective on relationships within the industry.

AGENCIES

Hayden Panettiere passes away at 36

She was known for her roles in ‘Heroes’ and ‘Nashville’



Hayden Panettiere, star of popular television series including ‘Heroes’ and ‘Nashville’, has died. She was 36. Panettiere’s father, Skip, announced her death in a statement provided to ‘ABC News’ on Sunday.

“It is with profound sadness that we share the tragic passing of our beloved Hayden. She was an incredible light and a force of nature who brought immeasurable love and joy to all who knew her - and to the millions who watched her onscreen,” his statement said.

No cause of death was announced and a publicist for Hayden Panettiere didn’t immediately respond to an email from ‘The Associated Press’.

Panettiere had a prolific career dating to 1996 and her credits included the voice of Dot in ‘A

SHE HAD BEEN OPEN ABOUT HER STRUGGLES WITH ALCOHOL ADDICTION AND DEPRESSION

Bug’s Life’, ‘Remember the Titans’ and ‘Scream VI’. Her role as a cheerleader with superpowers in ‘Heroes’ propelled her to fame, with the series revolving around the mantra “Save the cheerleader, save the world.”

She had been open about her struggles with alcohol addiction and depression, including after the birth of her daughter in 2014. In a memoir published this year, titled ‘This Is Me: A Reckoning’, she wrote about her decision to give full custody of her daughter to her former partner, boxer Wladimir Klitschko. AGENCIES